MACHINE TRANSCRIPT · CORAGGIO CONSULTING

Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Tuesday, February 17, 2026

Date	Tuesday, February 17, 2026
Place	Senate of Virginia, Senate Chamber, State Capitol, Richmond
Length	5h 7m (video)

- Official floor video (Senate of Virginia, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wGlJv48_tc0
- LIS Senate minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/S

> Machine transcript (speech-to-text) produced by Coraggio Consulting. Not an official county record. Names and numbers may be misspelled; check the video at the timestamp before quoting.

Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-18. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:18] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:00:24] Senate chamber.

[00:01:23] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:02:34] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:03:39] Chamber.

[00:04:39] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:07:25] Chamber.

[00:08:02] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:09:18] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:10:22] Senate chamber.

[00:10:59] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

[00:13:04] Senate chamber.

[00:14:05] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:15:45] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[00:17:20] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

[00:20:25] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[00:21:42] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[00:23:41] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[00:26:46] be sure to stay connected with live sessions catch up on past meetings and explore our full archives

[00:27:53] anytime on the senate of virginia's youtube channel this is the senate of virginia richmond

[00:28:59] virginia chamber the senate will come to order the senators will please take their seats those

[00:31:14] persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery the senators and all in attendance will please stand if you are able. We will be led in prayer today by Cantor Jason Kaufman from Bethel Hebrew Congregation in Alexandria. And following the prayer, everyone will please remain standing and be led in the Pledge of Allegiance today

[00:31:43] to the flag of the United States of America by Senate Page Vashnavi Lanka of Fairfax. of all life, bless the work of this chamber. May those entrusted with power use the immense authority granted in this room to protect the vulnerable and to defend the rights and dignity of every human being. In this moment when our shared values are being tested and our common bonds feel strained, may we

[00:32:22] strive to be a commonwealth where all are welcomed and protected. May every law emanates from this historic chamber be shaped by compassion, guided by justice, and grounded in the belief that all are made B'Tselem Elohim in the image of God.

[00:32:43] And may we have gratitude for those who engage in this sacred work. Today, in particular, we thank God for the career of Senator Adam Eben, a humble public servant who has served as a model for us all. Senator Eben, as you conclude your service in the Senate today and embark on a new chapter of public life, it is my great honor to offer you the oldest blessing of our shared Jewish tradition,

[00:33:21] the priestly benediction.

[00:33:35] bless you and keep you. May the Lord shine his countenance upon you and be gracious unto you. And may God grant you the most important gift of all, the gift

[00:34:07] of peace and together we say amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the Republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and joy. Thank you so much. Clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye. The clerk will close the roll. You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate journal for Monday, February 16th, 2026.

[00:35:25] The senator from King George moves that the reading of the journal be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[00:35:42] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 33, noes 6. Ayes 33, noes 6. The reading of the journal is waived.

[00:35:58] The clerk will report any communications from the House of Delegates. The Chair recognizes the Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Good morning, Madam President. Good morning. Madam President, I move to waive reading of the communication from the House of Delegates. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived?

[00:36:13] All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll.

[00:36:29] Ayes 33, noes 7. Ayes 33, noes 7. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the governor. I do not have any, Madam President.

[00:36:45] We've now arrived at the time in our morning hour when we have the honor of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us this evening, or this afternoon, I should say, in the Senate gallery. I give my daily reminder about our procedure.

[00:37:01] A senator will rise and provide an introduction for their visitors. And then I will offer the welcome of the Senate. I ask that we all hold our applause until I've had the opportunity to provide the Senate's welcome.

[00:37:17] The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Thank you, Madam President Rice, for two introductions. The senator has the floor. First, I want to introduce Cantor Jason Kaufman, who gave our invocation today, and thank him for coming down.

[00:37:32] I've known Jason for the 13 years he's been at Temple Bethel in Alexandria, Bethel Hebrew Congregation, which is one of the oldest Jewish congregations of the Commonwealth founded in the 1850s. He is a faith leader, a teacher, a community organizer, and a social justice activist. His colleagues have recognized him by electing him to be the Vice President of Organizational Relationships for the American conference of cantors and he lives in the seminary hill area of alexandria my district with his husband delegate-elect kirk mcpike who's also in the gallery who will be sworn in tomorrow

[00:38:10] to succeed delegate bennett parker and kirk has the distinction of um being my campaign manager for state senate in 2011 so if you like what i've done you can thank him if you have any issues take him up with kirk but um if you could extend to them the warm welcome of the senate thank you Senator for that introduction and welcome to Cantor Jason Kaufman for the beautiful beautiful prayer most especially for the the gift of the blessing that you provided on our senator from Alexandria. Thank you for

[00:38:44] that warm blessing and welcome also to our Delegate-Elect Kirk McPike. We are excited to see you sworn into office tomorrow and we're so happy that you are able to join us with your husband this morning and welcome to both of you.

[00:39:02] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to Cantor Kaufman and to delegate-elect Kirk McPike. Senator from Alexandria. Yes, thank you Madam President. My second

introduction is two of the interns from the team in my office who've done a great job this session. We've had a lot of interns over the years and the University of Richmond and VCU have never let us down and this here is no different. I wanted to ask you to welcome to the Senate Danielle

[00:39:42] Esauci and of the U of R and Priscilla Acobia Arco from VCU. You could extend some of the greetings to the Senate. Well thank you Senator for that introduction and welcome to Danielle and to Priscilla. I hope you have both enjoyed wonderful experiences throughout your internship program here in the senator's office I'm sure you've learned a lot and thank you for the contributions that you have made to his Senate office senators I ask that we give the warm

[00:40:16] welcome of the Senate to our visitors interns in the senator's office Danielle and Priscilla the chair recognizes the senator from Norfolk thank you madam thank you madam president I rise for the purpose of an introduction the senator has the floor thank you madam president it is my honor to introduce 60 students from norfolk public schools and i would ask them to stand norfolk public schools is the

[00:40:52] cornerstone of a proudly diverse community these students join us today from blair middle school and the academy of international studies at rosemont all 60 students are currently enrolled in civics and economics and they are accompanied by on the floor by their civics teacher rebecca burley and kelly oxy from the academy of international studies at rosemont and elisa jackson from blair middle school they are also joined by jennifer lopez not the actress singer

[00:41:28] but jennifer lope the senior coordinator of history and social science for norfolk public schools as well as teacher specialists christopher matthews and carrie miller we are also grateful before the support of Interim Superintendent Dr. James Pohl and members of the Norfolk School Board who were unable to join but help make this day possible.

[00:41:51] In their civics and economics courses, these students have been studying Virginia's political processes, the structure and responsibilities of state and local government, the lawmaking process, and the rights and responsibilities of citizenship. Today, they have come prepared with questions and are eager to see democracy in action, engaging thoughtfully and learning how to make their voices heard as informed citizens. Their visit represents a journey from vision to victory in civic learning and engagement. And this trip to the Capitol came out, Madam President, came out of an idea as we host Norfolk on the Capitol Day and other days where

[00:42:31] people come and one of the former school board members said we should have the students here and I said to her you just said a word we got you and so we have all of these 60 students representing would you please join me and the members of the Senate and giving a warm welcome to the students from Norfolk Public Schools I just as a reminder about our procedure the senator will provide an introduction I will then offer the welcome of the Senate and then we will applaud our visitors but well-deserved applause certainly thank you senator for

[00:43:11] that introduction we are so delighted to have the students from Norfolk Public schools joining us today. 60 students is a lot to bring, so my thanks to the teachers and all the adults who have accompanied our students on this amazing experience. I hope you're having a wonderful visit at the Capitol and getting to talk to many of our leaders and learning a lot. I'm sure you are.

[00:43:37] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate now to the representatives the students of norfolk public schools the chair recognizes the senator from eastern henrico thank you madam president i rise for an introduction the senator has the floor thank you madam president it is with great pleasure that i recognize the dedicated leaders and staff and volunteers of the march of dimes and i'd ask that they please stand

[00:44:16] madam president these dedicated leaders have been leading the fight to improve maternal and infant health outcomes in our capital we are honored to acknowledge an organization whose mission and service have been made profound have made profound differences in the lives of families across the commonwealth and throughout our nation beyond research and public health initiatives march of dimes partners with health care providers policy makers and local advocates and organizations to advance policies that expand access to quality care and promote equitable outcomes for every mother

[00:44:51] in every child madam president we are grateful for their presence today and their unwavering dedication to improving those health outcomes and so madam president i'd ask that you join me in giving them the warm welcome of our senate thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to the representatives and the leaders from march of dimes we know how uh how important and very critical the work is that you do we are so grateful that you do this very necessary work thank you for your leadership, and I hope you're having a wonderful visit here at the Capitol.

[00:45:27] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to our representatives from the March of Dimes. The chair recognizes the senator from Charlottesville. Thank you, Madam Chair. I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Today we're joined by AmeriCorps members, program staff, and commission staff. We're also joined by members of the the governor's advisory board on service and volunteerism and the Virginia

[00:46:02] Service Foundation. AmeriCorps is a powerful national service program that engages Americans across the nation to come together, uniting them in common purpose to meet local needs and build stronger communities. Through this meaningful service, AmeriCorps members gain valuable workforce skills, earn education awards, and develop a lifelong commitment to citizenship, benefiting their families, their communities, and the Commonwealth as a whole. AmeriCorps members are active in the district I represent, supporting high school students as they explore post-secondary pathways, building relationships with recently resettled refugee families, and supporting rural communities with health

[00:46:41] education and outreach. AmeriCorps programs, along with their other community service initiatives, including the Governor's Awards on volunteerism and community service are supported by serve virginia the virginia service foundation and the governor's advisory board on service and volunteerism i would appreciate it madam chair if you would extend the warm welcome of the senate to our americorps guest today thank you thank you thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to the representatives from americorps and also from the governor's advisory board thank you for all that you do to provide so much

[00:47:17] necessary support and insights to our communities. We appreciate greatly the hard work and dedication that you continuously display. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to our representatives from AmeriCorps and the Governor's Advisory Board. The chair recognizes the

senator from Eastern Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Today

[00:47:54] arise to recognize an organization whose work is transforming maternal health outcomes across the Commonwealth of Virginia, Birth and Color. Founded in 2018, Birth and Color is a Virginia-based nonprofit dedicated to addressing maternal and infant health disparities through culturally responsive care, workforce development, and public policy advocacy. The organization provides doula services, childbirth education, lactation support, father engagement programming and reproductive health resources to families across our state.

[00:48:28] Birth in Color is the only black-led reproductive justice organization in the commonwealth of Virginia focused specifically on advancing black maternal health through both direct services and systems change. Their work is rooted in ensuring that families have the right to safe pregnancies, safe births, and safe communities in which to raise their children. In addition, Birth in Color operates the largest doula collective in the state of Virginia, specializing in black maternal health.

[00:48:58] Each year, the organization supports hundreds of families, offers free childbirth education and lactation clinics, and works alongside policymakers to advance legislation that address maternal mortality, improves postpartum care, and expands access to comprehensive reproductive health care.

[00:49:15] Members, please join me in recognizing Birth in Color for its leadership, service, and dedication to the health of families throughout the Commonwealth. - Thank you, Senator, for that introduction, and thank you to the representatives from Birth and Color for joining us here for your Advocacy Day.

[00:49:33] Your efforts over the many years have already produced tangible results in improving maternal health, in improving the lives of infants, and making a real difference in the communities you represent and serve. So thank you for all that you do.

[00:49:50] Thank you, especially for your leadership in so many ways. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives and leaders from birth and color. The chair recognizes the senator from Stafford.

[00:50:12] Thank you. OK, thank you. Thank you, Madam President. Today in the gallery. Well, for what purpose do you rise? I'm sorry, I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Today, we welcome to the Capitol. we have over 90 students from the rise up homeschool ministry that's based right in my district that's visiting the state capitol and i think we've got the high school students i'm told and the rest of the gang is watching because i've been able to fit all 90 kids in here so um yes they've this group of students represents a really strong tradition of parental community

[00:50:49] based education here in the commonwealth um i had a chance to meet with them earlier this morning and madam president i was so impressed with uh they had repeated questions we ran out of time they're so inquisitive and so bright the future is indeed bright with these kids i'm honored they have taken the time to visit us here and serve the legislative process and learn more about their state government if their how their government works experiences like this inspire the next generation to stay involved in the communities and public service so i hope that it will be the warm welcome to the summit thank you very much matter president

[00:51:26] senator thank you for that introduction and welcome to our high school students it looks like out of the 90 that are visiting us today in the capitol visiting from rise up home school ministry we are so delighted that you are here and i hope you're having wonderful visits as you speak to your legislators throughout the day and i know you're learning a lot and you have had a great meeting with your senator from Stafford. We're happy to have you and hope that your rest of the day continues well. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the students from Rise Up Homeschool

[00:52:05] Ministry. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor.

[00:52:22] Thank you so much, Madam President. In the gallery is my good friend Julie Stanley who is chair of the Virginia Service Foundation which supports serve Virginia and she reached out to the faculty at John R Lewis High School and their John R Lewis leadership program to bring students down to advocate for a bill that was championed by the namesake of their school John Lewis the the historic civil rights leader and they are here today to advocate for for the bill, and I wish that you give them the warm welcome of the Senate.

[00:52:56] Well, thank you, Senator, for that introduction, and thank you to Julie and to the John Lewis Leadership Program students for being here and for sharing how critical and important this program is and all that you are learning and working on.

[00:53:12] I hope you've had some wonderful discussions with your legislators and a wonderful visit on the Capitol today. We're delighted to have you. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of the John Lewis Leadership Program.

[00:53:29] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Henrico. Thank you, Madam President.

[00:53:45] Madam President, I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I believe we have in the gallery here with us today members from the Chesapeake Climate Action Network and Sierra Club. Maybe not. They're here.

[00:54:02] Okay, I would just ask that you would give them the warm House welcome as they are here, a warm Senate. See, we've been sending these love notes to the House all morning, so my mind was on the House. And so now I need to get re-centered.

[00:54:19] Would you give them the warm Senate welcome as they are here to speak with us about things that are important to them related to Climate Action Lobby Day? Thank you, Senator, for that introduction and welcome.

[00:54:36] We see a strong contingent up in our gallery. Welcome to the Climate Action Network representatives as well as the Sierra Club representatives. Thank you for your consistent and dedicated work on so many critical priorities and areas of legislative as well as budget concerns.

[00:54:57] I hope you've been having wonderful discussions with our lawmakers throughout the day today. We certainly see the impact that your advocacy is having on the issues and the topics that we are focused on. Thank you for your continued effort.

[00:55:13] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to our representatives from the climate lobbyist communities.

[00:55:34] Is there any other business for the morning hour? The clerk will call the calendar.

[00:55:52] Senate calendar for Tuesday, February 17th, 2026. Unfinished Business Senate. Senate Joint Resolution 69. The chair recognizes the-- --by the House with amendment.

[00:56:11] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we concur with the House amendments. Speaking to that motion-- The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. The House made some additional amendments to SJRs, you will see coming up 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, and 74. And that is the amendment should be in your

[00:56:39] calendar madam president and with that move is passed. The question is shall house joint resolution

[00:56:52] 69 pass the question the question is shall the senate concur with the amendments from the house on sjr 69 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators

[00:57:28] ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 22 noes 18 ayes 22 noes 18 the senate concurs with the house amendments Senate joint resolution 70 has been agreed to by the house with amendment.

[00:57:57] Senator from Virginia, Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the Senate concur with the House amendments on SJR 70 and having previously explained the amendments, I move that we concur with the House.

[00:58:14] The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House amendments on SJR 70? all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 21 nose 19 eyes 21 nose 19 the senate concurs with the house amendments

[00:58:52] senate joint resolution 71 has been agreed to by the house with amendment junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you Madam President. I move that the Senate concur with the House and Senate Joint Resolution 71. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House amendments to SJR 71?

[00:59:21] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? the clerk will close the roll as 21 nose 19 eyes 21 nose 19 the senate concurs senate joint resolution 72 has been agreed to by the house with amendment junior senator from virginia beach thank you madam president i move that the senate concur with the house on amendments

[01:00:01] to sjr 72. the question is shall the senate concur with the house amendments to sjr 72 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 21 nose 19 eyes 21 nose 19 the senate concurs with the house

[01:00:34] amendments senate joint resolution 73 has been agreed to by the house with amendment junior senator from virginia beach thank you madam president i move that the senate concur with the house on senate joint resolution 73 amendments the question is shall the senate concur with the house amendments to sjr 73 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change

[01:01:10] their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. The Senate concurs. Senate Joint Resolution 74 agreed to by the House with amendment. Junior Senator from Virginia Beach.

[01:01:28] Thank you Madam President. I move that the Senate concur with the House amendments on Senate Joint Resolution 74. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the amendments made by the House on Senate Joint Resolution 74. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Of all the senators voted, do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. The Senate

[01:02:02] concurs with the House amendments on SJR 74. Regular calendar Senate bills on third reading.

[01:02:08] Senate Bill 643, a bill relating to firearm purchase agreements penalties, reported from, I'm sorry, there is a floor substitute.

[01:02:47] No. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Parliamentary query man present. This is on third reading, we're not moving the sub, right?

[01:03:06] No, that was my mistake. Got it, okay, good. So I move the bill pass, and I'm not good, but thank you, Madam Clerk. I move the bill pass and speak of that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, we had kind of a lengthy discussion about this yesterday.

[01:03:23] I'm not sure I need to revisit it again, but the bill basically creates a prohibition on the purchase of assault rifles and handguns by people under the age of 21, and it prohibits possession of those guns by anyone at the age of 18 except for the exceptions that are listed in code and what would be in the code the practical effect of this aside from what I just stated would also be to allow the Virginia State Police to begin providing background check services for private firearm sales again right now they're enjoined from doing that because of a case out of Lynchburg this would take care of that legal problem and allow that

[01:04:02] to again to proceed so I hope we could pass this bill so that we can make sure the wrong people aren't getting guns the question is shall Senate bill 66 Ford 3 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll that's 21 knows 19

[01:04:36] Ayes 21, Nose 19. Senate Bill 643 passes. Senate Bill 807, a bill relating to hunting within certain areas of Monroe Bay prohibited. Westmoreland County.

[01:04:54] The Senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass in speaking to that. The Senator has the floor. It's a new day, Madam President. I'm hoping that this bill does better today, although I'm not optimistic.

[01:05:07] This is again a request from the locality. The town of Colonial Beach adopted a unanimous resolution. The Westmoreland County Board of Supervisors adopted a unanimous resolution to ask the General Assembly to restrict a very small sliver of water from hunting because people have now started hunting next to restaurants and marinas and right next to people's homes.

[01:05:38] and it's just creating a lot of consternation and I hope that we can allow the town and the county to restrict this area it is special legislation so if you can find it in your heart to vote for it I sure would appreciate it if you would the question is shall Senate bill 807 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to

[01:06:15] change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 17. Ayes 23, noes 17. Because the bill requires a vote of 27, the bill does not pass. Senate Bill 783, a bill relating to law enforcement agencies' agreements with federal authority for immigration enforcement requirements. The senator

[01:06:53] from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill pass and speaking to that motion the senator has the floor thank you madam president senate bill 783 is about a clear principle virginia law enforcement should not be drafted into doing federal immigration agents work in ways that make our communities less safe less trusting and less free senate bill 783 creates a framework in the code of virginia for any cooperation between local law enforcement and federal immigration authorities. It draws a bright line to keep immigration

[01:07:29] enforcement out of our schools, hospitals, polling places, and houses of worship and ensures that routine policing is not turned into an immigration mission. No questioning about citizenship or immigration status during routine contacts. Senate Bill 783 also requires judicial warrant before sensitive information is shared for immigration enforcement or before entering a person's home. This is one of our core constitutional freedom enshrined in the Fourth Amendment of the Bill of Rights, but the Trump administration has failed to obey the Constitution. We must do what we can to protect the rights of

[01:08:07] Virginians. This is not about an abstract debate. We are debating how federal immigration enforcement is operating right now in our communities. Many of us have stories of ICE raids in our districts. I can tell you stories about people I know who were wrongfully sent to Farmville. Everyone in this chamber represents constituents who are living in fear right before, right now, before all of this. It is also strengthening reporting when federal agents are present so that the public can see what is happening in our

[01:08:43] communities. In Minneapolis, federal agents fatally shot two U.S. citizens, both 37 years old American citizens Minnesota law enforcement have has been unable to investigate the death of these two Minnesotans at the hands of federal agents this cannot be allowed to happen in Virginia when local law enforcement becomes extension of federal immigration enforcement trust erodes immigration or immigrant families will stop calling 9-1-1 domestic violence survivors will stay silent, workers don't report wage theft or unsafe conditions, and parents

[01:09:21] fear sending their kids to school or going to the doctors. Public safety requires trust. Trust you cannot have when people fear a traffic stop, a school visit, or a hospital trip which could lead to detention or worse. Since President Trump was inaugurated, 75% of Virginians arrested by ICE have no criminal history. ICE officers get just 47 days of training to honor the 47th president. We see the results on the ground. A poorly trained undisciplined

[01:09:56] force that escalates and creates conflict at every opportunity. We do not want our well-trained local police units to be tarred with that brush. This bill makes it clear if ICE wants to cooperate or have cooperations they have to start doing things the right way let me be clear nothing in Senate bill 783 stops local police from doing their job investigating crimes and arresting dangerous people or cooperating with federal authorities on serious criminal investigation it is simply saying that civil immigration enforcement must be

[01:10:34] handled carefully transparently and in ways that respects the Constitution and and its rights. The major cities chiefs association representing our nation's largest police department has stated that immigration enforcement by local police would undermine the trust and the cooperation with immigrant

communities which are essentially elements of community-oriented policing. Senate Bill 783 is not radical it is responsible it keeps local policing focused on real public safety protecting sensitive space ensuring transparency and reaffirming that no

[01:11:11] agency federal or state is above the constitution or the value of a human life madam president with that i renew my motion that we pass this bill the chair recognizes the senator from colonial heights thank you madam president speaking to the bill the senator has the floor uh madam president uh i think it's important we be very clear about what this bill does especially after it was amended on the floor yesterday i think there were a total of five floor amendments that i don't recall haven't seen been been done at least in recent history but this is a very different bill now

[01:11:49] after the amendments that were made yesterday and as i read over it last night as amended it becomes very clear that this is really just the very same anti-law enforcement defund the police playbook that we have been watching play out over the last five years it's a different badge this time but it's the exact same script make cooperation harder second-guess decisions in real time add in legal traps for police and then act surprised when public safety gets worse in 2020 and 2021 during riots and unrest we were told that law enforcement was the problem not criminals

[01:12:28] not violent gangs but police and so here in virginia the general assembly responded the same way as is happening now more second guessing more legal traps and more politics inject injected into policing this bill has that very same mindset at its core it points the defund movement at federal law enforcement and it drags our virginia officers along with it and so let's start with the core of this bill this bill at its core effectively tells virginia law enforcement that they cannot cooperate with federal immigration enforcement that is not oversight that is a stand

[01:13:08] down policy then come the floor amendments that were added yesterday that this body adopted that make the bill even more extreme they take a stand down bill and turn virginia into a sanctuary state in every corner of the commonwealth not just in one city not just one county but everywhere first amendment that was adopted is the polling place amendment and this one is revealing it It creates a sanctuary zone around polling places while polls are open and while ballots are being counted.

[01:13:43] Madam President, if someone is not legally eligible to vote, what on earth would they be doing at the polls? And if this body thinks that is a real concern, why would we create a protected perimeter? At the very place we should be most serious about lawful elections.

[01:14:01] Second was the technology amendment that was added to this bill yesterday. That amendment restricts basic investigative tools used to locate the right people and avoid mistakes. Phone location tools and digital forensics are how investigators connect the right person to the right network, including MS-13 and other violent gangs.

[01:14:24] Those tools are used to disrupt human trafficking, locate victims before they're moved again, and confirm identities. Taking away those tools does not make enforcement safer. It just makes Virginia a more attractive place criminals to hide third is the home entry amendment that was adopted yesterday and i understand the instinct there but this amendment is not a balanced fourth amendment rule it is a categorical shield written for immigration enforcement even where consent exists and here's

[01:14:57] the absurdity even if the homeowner says come in the amendment still says no consent doesn't matter urgency doesn't matter a victim begging for help doesn't matter and it elevates paperwork over

reality and it tells bad actors exactly how to operate. Move it indoors and you'll be safe. Fourth was the amendment adopted yesterday that tries to impose Virginia arrest rules on federal agents. That is not clarity. Officers are now going to have to guess which rulebook controls in real time. And then after the

[01:15:35] fact, every hard call becomes a lawsuit. Every incident becomes political. That is defund the police era written into the Code of Virginia. Finally, the agent involved firearms provision. That amendment mandates a state police investigation and says any such incident is quote-unquote subject to prosecution. That language right there invites politicized prosecution.

[01:16:03] Using language like subject to prosecution is not how responsible legislatures write criminal justice policy. It's how you signal a target and then hope the process delivers the outcome that you want. Madam President, when you add all of this up, it's clear what's going on here. This is not about public safety. It's about ideology. It's the defund the police mindset repackaged against a new law enforcement target. And it makes Virginia a sanctuary state in every corner of the commonwealth. And I'd urge the Senate to vote no. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:16:41] The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the bill. the senator has the floor thank you madam president it was interesting to hear that attempt to try to explain why folks would vote against law enforcement having to follow basic standards rules and things like our Constitution the reality of ice right now is the nation's terrified of them and it's not just people who are undocumented the entire country is ice if you go look at the

[01:17:19] ice is approval ratings right now or what people think of them I think that they stand at something like 60% of Americans disapprove of ice tactics they've engaged in blatant racial profiling they've engaged in warrantless they've actually wrote a memo saying it's okay to go into somebody's home without a search warrant without exigent circumstances they've opened up these detention centers if you only want to call them that that are overcrowded we don't feed people give them access to counsel it's so unpopular that even

[01:17:55] Hanover County wouldn't accept that think about that for a second Augusta County wouldn't accept it either just think about it 32 people have died in custody in the last 12 months there's been at least at least 20 to 30 shootings there's been other bystanders that have been shot they killed a poet and they killed they killed a nurse who attends to our veterans after disarming him they took his gun off him and then shot him. Where was the outcry from the Second Amendment community when the government took a gun off somebody and then

[01:18:34] assassinated him in public? And then when the government tried to cover it up? These are the things that I thought certain members of a certain party used to defend. Now, Madam President, all the bill does is say that if any of our law enforcement want to cooperate with these thugs, they have to agree to follow Virginia law. God forbid. Let's talk about the polling places. Who sends police to polling places?

[01:19:09] Why do police need to stand around a polling place? Why do you need to have a law enforcement present, people with semi-automatic weapons, standing around a polling place? You know why? It's to tell people to go away, everybody. It's to scare people not to vote. And the Trump administration has made clear that they want to federalize our elections, they want to take over, And by the way, which the Constitution says are our pure responsibility.

[01:19:34] But they have said they want to federalize elections and they want to basically take over state voting. These aren't ungrounded fears. These are things that the president has said he wants to do. All this technology. The bill says they can use their technology as long as they're only going after violent felons, which is what President Trump claimed he wanted to do when he ran for office.

[01:19:59] Instead of 75% of the people arrested in Virginia don't even have criminal convictions. ICE does not need these creepy tools to surveil and follow people around. We didn't do anything to restrict the FBI or the DEA.

[01:20:15] If any other federal agency wants to use that stuff to go and enforce their criminal laws, they're welcome to do it. Just ICE can't if they want to operate in Virginia. Let's talk about the so-called defund the police strategies or whatever it was I just heard.

[01:20:31] Madam President, the laws that we passed in 2020. I want to remind everybody the law that the senator from Hampton carried was co-written with law enforcement the Chiefs of Police Association supported it they helped write it they said it's not reasonable to have chokeholds they said we don't shoot into moving cars that's against training they said here are the standards when you want to use deadly force we're happy to codify them so now something that was written by law enforcement written by Virginia law

[01:21:10] enforcement leadership. Now the other side is contending that that's anti-law enforcement. What planet are we on? Have we really come that far? Madam President, I would submit that the only people who want to defund the police are the people that are going to vote against the collective bargaining bill in a minute, which is the only opportunity police might have to fund themselves. I want you to think about that before you take your vote in a few minutes. The chair recognizes the senator from King, George. Speaking to the bill, Madam President. The

[01:21:48] Senator has the floor um thank you madam president so as i understand this bill and i tried to read it and understand and participate as this has gone through the process effectively what this is going to do is it's going to affect our 287g agreements that localities enter into with um ice and thus far through this process i understand that there have been things that have happened and and i'm speaking specifically to virginia um there were arrests made that perhaps someone shouldn't have been detained and i'm not aware of those in my area but i've heard the gentleman speak

[01:22:28] about those in northern virginia and and some other places i understand that more dramatic things happened across the country but by and large if you enter into an agreement with ice things are going to go much more smoothly.

[01:22:47] If our local officers cooperate, if they have an individual that is on the NCIC, the criminal watch list, and they're told to detain them, and then they come pick them up and do the deportation or whatever it calls for, those generally occur without incident.

[01:23:08] And we've been doing that for 50 years. We did it under President Obama. We did it under President Biden. We're doing it under President Trump now. The problem is this. When you put all these restrictions in place and say, if you want Virginia to cooperate with you, then you've got to abide by all of these things.

[01:23:32] A couple of those amendments were reasonable yesterday and I voted for. And I think they were proper due process matters. But there are other things that actually restrict their ability to stop

terrorist attacks. There are many other things in the original bill which actually cripple law enforcement and their ability to do a job.

[01:23:55] And what's sad about this thing is this, I know that it's well-intentioned, the folks that are pushing this bill, but by saying to President Trump, we're not going to cooperate with you unless you play by our rules, and here are the rules, and effectively you're not going to be able to do your job if you play by these rules.

[01:24:18] I fear that you all have now just put a target on the backs of the very people that you think you're going to help. The chair recognizes the senator from Rockingham. Madam President, speaking of the bill.

[01:24:34] The senator has the floor. You know, every once in a while, rhetoric heats up to a superheated point in here and elsewhere. I want to point you to some statistics, though.

[01:24:53] If you look at the relative deportation rates of the past three presidents, the deportation rate under President Trump does not even come close to that of the Obama administration under which for eight years the Obama administration deported 400,000 immigrants per year.

[01:25:27] Under the Biden administration we had just absolute open borders but even with open borders under the Biden administration they were sending about, deporting about 271,000 people.

[01:25:46] During all of President Trump's term he has deported on average about 267,000 people per year. Not even approaching that of the Biden administration highs. And I'm here to tell you that, you know, I believe that there is something that ought to be added to DSM-IV, and that is Trump Derangement Syndrome.

[01:26:12] Some people just absolutely froth at the mouth when it comes to policies and actions under this particular administration. They are quick to accuse everybody who bears the same political affiliation with culpability for every bad thing that happens under the administration.

[01:26:38] And under cover of that, they seek to adopt some of the most extreme left-wing, defund the police policies. And you know, this is a playbook we've seen before.

[01:26:57] We've seen it in Virginia and we've seen it across the country. people on this side, and I'm just sick and tired of being accused of condoning criminal conduct. I don't, we don't, we believe criminal conduct should be punished.

[01:27:17] People should be held accountable for it, whether it's committed by civilians, whether it's committed by criminals in our community, whether it's committed by criminal illegal aliens in our community, or whether it's committed by police.

[01:27:33] that's the kind of accountability that we stand for and we believe you know we go back just a few years and of course in Minnesota again we had the George Floyd incident nobody commended or excused criminal conduct there yet across the country we had riots and we had proposals across the country to defund the police and absolutely turn our communities into free-for-alls. What

[01:28:11] comes of that though is a thoughtful, what came of it was a, ultimately, a negotiated package that did take into account the concerns of law enforcement, the chiefs of police, the sheriff's association, and we came out with legislation that has basically worked and allows us to hold law enforcement accountable.

[01:28:42] But that's not what we're doing here. That is not what we are doing here. We're following the old defund the police playbook in which we use something criminal, potentially criminal, something bad that happens in another state to absolutely try to adopt the most extreme response we possibly can in the name of partisan politics, messaging, positioning, and to try and get some political weaponization of that issue.

[01:29:18] What has found its way into this bill is, as my friends, the Senator from King George and Senator from Colonial Heights have pointed out, is frankly irresponsible. It is not taking into account the safety of our communities.

[01:29:38] You know, I can count, and I know that this is going to pass this chamber. It's going to pass presumably down the hall, and I assume that the governor is going to fix her signature to it. And let me tell you, I hope and I pray that nothing bad will befall citizens of the Commonwealth of Virginia over the next year as a consequence of a political messaging bill.

[01:30:07] I hope we'll vote no on this, but I can count. The chair recognizes the senator from Orange. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the bill. The senator has the floor.

[01:30:24] Madam President, I'm not shocked at all by the comments that are coming from the floor today. We're so close to D.C., and I've always believed that politics is a lot like mold. You see it growing in the grout in the shower, and if you don't take care of it and kill it with bleach, it takes over the whole shower.

[01:30:43] That's politics. It's mold in the shower, and we got a lot of mold in here today. Madam President, I'd like to talk a little bit, since we're talking about the bigger issue other than the bill and the contents of the bill, I'd like to associate my comments with the senator from Colonial Heights, King George, and Rockingham.

[01:31:01] A good friend of mine is actually the ICE director, Tom Homan, and he's a damn good friend. And I'm going to tell you, in 2015, I had the opportunity to go to the White House, the Obama White House, and watch Mr. Homan get the presidential award as a distinguished executive for his leadership in immigration enforcement.

[01:31:23] The guy that everybody hates right now is Donald Trump and Tom Homan. Why? Because they're enforcing the laws of the United States. You see, on our side, we believe it's about the rule of law and enforcing that law. And yes, they'd like to go after those criminals 'cause they've got so many of those criminals that have done some heinous things, but what's a law enforcement officer supposed to do he finds somebody else who has broken the laws of our country by illegally getting here, just let them go free? That's not what law enforcement officers do. They take an oath to support and defend the Constitution of the United States against all enemies, foreign, domestic, and bear

[01:32:00] truth, faith, and allegiance to the same. They have to uphold those laws. Sure, they have discretion, but they're going to enforce the law. That's what they're doing. If we can't enforce the law, then the law is going to run rampant. I'm grateful that we have a president that wants to correct an issue that happened under another administration where 5.6 million illegal aliens were released into the interior by the Biden administration and up to 2 million getaways. And we're complaining about law enforcement outside of voting.

[01:32:35] The American people aren't that stupid. They're just not that stupid. Everybody knows what's going on here. Let's call it like it is. Madam President, I'm going to hope that my colleagues all vote no on this. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, speaking to the Bill?

[01:32:55] The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, I just want to briefly level set kind of what we're talking about here because what I'm hearing right now is I'm hearing a lot of people trying to kick up as much dirt as possible to try to make it so that the citizens can't see what's really happening.

[01:33:16] I remember a day ago a couple of amendments that got pretty large bipartisan votes around constitutional rights, around protecting Virginia citizens. And today, what I'm hearing is I'm hearing buzzwords, I'm hearing right-wing talking points, the dust is, they're trying to kick up dust because what they want the average citizen in Virginia to forget is the words on the page and the visuals that they're seeing across the country.

[01:33:43] They don't want you to believe what you can see with your own eyes. They don't want you to see masked people arresting five-year-olds. They don't want you to see cops going into doors, knocking down doors without warrants.

[01:34:00] They don't want you to see people being shot when they're helpless. And the game is given away about how unnecessary all this is by the senator from Rockingham's own comments.

[01:34:15] There was a very good president who did two terms and deported a whole lot of more people. And he did it legally, constitutionally, and he respected people's rights. There's a way to do this without causing all this chaos.

[01:34:30] There's a way to do this without taking away people's rights. So I would just ask all the citizens of Virginia, ignore the dust, wait till you get through it, and then remember what you saw with your own eyes. Because that's what this bill is addressing. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:34:45] The chair recognizes a senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I rise to speak to the bill. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. So as I'm sitting here listening to my colleagues from the other side talking about these ICE agents as these respectable law enforcement, public servants, and I, like my colleague on this side, am trying really hard not to feel as if I'm being gaslit right now.

[01:35:22] By the end of February 2026, ICE has hired over 12,000 new agents, doubling its workforce. This recruitment drive has included bonuses of $50,000, lowering the average age of an agent from 21 to 18.

[01:35:47] And as we know from brain development, 18-year-old male brains are not developed to make appropriate decisions they've also reduced training to as little as 47 days and what we have seen in our streets are masked men who are going after children who are trying to incite fear and chaos into our communities and this is not made up come

[01:36:21] into our communities talk to our constituents this is real I had a group of high schoolers come to me the other day and tell me that in their school they're scared to come because certain classmates now go around and tell them that they're going to call up ICE so that they can get deported that's real fear that

did not just happen that's because it's being driven by an administration who has a clear goal and that is to incite fear and chaos into our

[01:36:57] communities and they're being successful and that's the reason I'm going to support this today because in my community I want my constituents my children to know that I am NOT okay with this and I'm not okay with where it's going and I do agree that we have a target on our back from the administration and that's exactly why we need to stand up and fight for the Commonwealth thank you madam president the chair recognizes the junior senator from virginia beach thank you my president speaking to the bill the senator has the floor

[01:37:36] i wasn't planning on speaking but hearing all the rhetoric around i'd like to go with the facts in early 2024 a bipartisan senate group brokered a strict immigration compromise to tighten border security which by president biden supported and aimed to pass donald trump urged republicans to block the bill to prevent a political victory for biden key details of that bipartisan deal was the Border Shutdown Authority would have allowed the president to shut down the border

[01:38:10] with daily average of migrants hitting 5,000 a day, a mandatory shutdown at 8,500. Asylum restrictions are aimed to overhaul the asylum system by speeding up the process times and narrowing eligibility, making it harder for migrants to claim asylum.

[01:38:26] Funding and resources, the deal included funding for more Border Patrol agents, immigration judges, and detention facilities. Trump opposed, stating the bill was a gift to Democrats and according to The Guardian, urged Republicans to reject it, arguing it was too weak and led to many of the same senators who negotiated voting against it. Now here we are in 2026 under President Trump's watch has failed yet to do something about the southern border. But when we talk about ICE agents and police officers,

[01:39:00] I was just curious and understanding, looking at the time that it takes to want to become a police officer. In fact, I wanted to look and see how long did it take for a person to receive his barber's license. Did you know it takes over 16 to 18 months, over 500 days just to get a barber's license to become a police officer?

[01:39:25] It takes 3 to 12 months for a hiring process. You go to police academy for 3 to 6 months. field training six weeks to four months of on-the-job training and then there's a probation period and just to become an ICE agent interacting with the public armed armed with guns takes 47 days 47 days and so while we're hearing different perspectives of of ICE agents doing

[01:39:58] this and that the problem is we have equipped ICE agents who are not trained to interact with the public within 30 days two people have already lost their lives so we're talking about putting legislation to keep americans safe what good is that legislation if the asians that we're putting on the streets don't even understand the law that they're intended to enforce and so speaking to the bill the measures that we have in place gives virginia's a sense of hope that at least agents

[01:40:37] ICE agents that are coming to Virginia on the streets, that have some sense of the law, only being on the streets for 47 days. With that, I urge this body to pass this legislation.

[01:40:55] The chair recognizes the senator from Alexandria. Speaking briefly to the bill. The senator has the floor. I just wanted to address some comments from my good friend, the senator from Orange.

[01:41:10] We normally talk, and I know where he's coming from. He respects law enforcement, stands by the rule of law, but today I think maybe he's in a parallel universe, or I feel like I'm in one, because Tom Homan, the so-called immigration czar, took $50,000 in a paper bag on camera, and then the Justice Department and the Trump administration told the FBI not to investigate that.

[01:41:31] I cannot respect someone like that leading our immigration enforcement, and it's just wrong and it's emblematic of this larger picture of um do what we want answer questions later or never answer questions or say it's fake news but this this bill needs to pass this has gone too far and we can't uh we need guard rails on on what's happening in this country in this commonwealth i ask that we vote for the bill senator from central fairfax madam president if nobody else

[01:42:06] wishes to speak the senator has the floor thank you madam president i i think you know i had some notes to to sort of talk about the some of these things um but most of my colleagues have said what i think i needed to say but i do want to remind folks um you know the folks on the other side of the aisle might be doing you know a lot of messaging but i'm simply not doing that um i'm seeking to give some comfort to thousands of men and women children in the commonwealth who are living in fear that federal agents might send them or their family members to a country they fled, or a country they have never been to, or a detention center they might have never

[01:42:45] leave. America is supposed to be the shiny city on the hill, the beacon of freedom for the oppressed. Virginia must stand up to the idea before the world decides that it was never really true. Madam President, a lot of folks have come to me and said, why do you bring up bills that that that want to protect a class that saw this nation as a home and you know when we talk about enforcing the law you know and I hesitate to share this where

[01:43:19] I have had relatives who have been arrested by ICE these are US citizens and spent more than two weeks in Farmvilleville so when people ask why do you carry these type of bills this is why we do it it's because there are thousands of Americans thousands of Virginians who cannot afford nor could they be in those places where they're law-abiding citizens and if the government wants to enforce those laws they have to go through a judicial process rather than choosing compassion and care this administration has chosen

[01:43:57] cruelty and this is one step that Virginia must stand up against so madam President with that I hope that we send a message not only to Washington but across the nation that we passed this bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 783 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators

[01:44:31] desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, Nose 19, Senate Bill 783 passes. Senate Bill 121, a bill relating to minimum wage, farm laborers, or farm employees.

[01:44:58] The Senator from Eastern, Prince William. Madam President, I move the bill pass in speaking to the bill. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This bill removes the farm worker exemption from the Virginia Minimum Wage Act and ensures that farm workers are covered by Virginia's minimum wage.

[01:45:13] The addition of a delayed enactment clause will allow time for employers to adjust to changes made by this legislation. This body has seen this legislation before in 2025, both passed both the House and Senate before being vetoed by the previous governor.

[01:45:30] I hope it is the will of the body to pass the bill again. The question is, shall Senate Bill 121 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 121 passes. Senate Bill 644. A bill relating to labor and employment, payment of wages,

[01:46:07] minimum wage, and overtime wages. Misclassification of workers' civil actions. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Mayor President, move the bill pass and speak of the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 644 is a bill that has to do with basically with wages. It clarifies the law with regard to wage theft. You all might remember we had some dialogue about this back in 2020, and this basically cleans up that bill that we did back then. It makes clear that general contractors can be held

[01:46:41] liable if subs don't pay their employees wages for which they were paid. It cleans up enforcement of the prevailing wage statute. It makes it clear who can enforce the minimum wage statute. It makes it also clear when worker misclassification happens who can bring suit and what the remedies are and how the damages work. It makes them all consistent between all different code sections. And the last thing it does is it cleans up the employee retaliation statute, which is what we had the floor amendment on yesterday. And those are situations when an blows the whistle on for either a violation of state or federal law and is

[01:47:21] fired for that. That's what the bill does and I hope we get passed the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 644 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk

[01:47:48] will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 19. Ayes 20, noes 19. Senate Bill 644 passes. Senate Bill 673, a bill relating to cyber-stalking penalty. The Senator from Mecklenburg. Madam President, I moved the passage of the bill in speaking to that. The Senator has the floor. Madam President, Virginia law does a reasonable job protecting people from stalkers who physically follow them.

[01:48:28] show up at their home or appear at their workplace what it does not address is the stalker who never leaves their couch and terrorizes someone around the clock through text social media phone calls and location tracking apps right now electronic harassment falls into a patchwork of general statutes that weren't designed for this conduct commonwealth's attorneys struggle to fit cyber stalking into frameworks built for in-person contact victims don't get the justice they deserve senate bill 673 closes that gap it makes cyber stalking which is defined as sending threatening

[01:49:04] or harassing electronic communications on two or more separate and distinct occasions within 90 days a class one misdemeanor a second conviction within five years is a class six felony and it addresses a particularly modern problem location tracking apps if someone is using a phone apt to monitor a victim's movements as part of a pattern of harassment that conduct is now addressed that remains true even if the victim once consented to location sharing before the relationship turned threatening since this bill covers electronic communications rather than physical conduct

[01:49:42] i want to address how we protect against overreach this bill doesn't say just doesn't just say two messages and you're a stalker. First, the messages have to be separate and distinct. Simply sending two messages within a couple of minutes of each other does not meet the standard.

[01:50:00] Second, subsection B creates an eight-factor test that judges and juries may use to assess whether the victim's fear was reasonable. Courts can look at things like the content and language of the communication, the frequency and timing, any history of violence between the parties whether the accused has claimed access to weapons whether they know where the victim lives or works and whether the victims whether the victim explicitly told them to stop this test matters because electronic communications is different from showing up at someone's door making it critical that we have a way to ensure an incident is in fact cyber stalking this creates

[01:50:40] a framework to make this distinction fairly protecting genuine victims without criminalizing someone for sending two annoying text messages. Finally, cyberstalking can and cyberstalkings can and do get off the couch and escalate their behavior. Under subsequent under subsection d if they move from electronic stalking to physical stalking in violation of a protective order their actions become a class 6 felony. Finally, victims receive advanced notice before an offender convicted under this bill is released from custody. This is a long overdue protection for

[01:51:18] real people facing real threats in the digital age. I hope it is the will of the body to pass this bill. The senator from King George. Madam President, would the senator yield for a quick question? Will the senator from Mecklenburg yield? Yes. Senator from King George has the floor.

[01:51:38] Thank you, Madam President. I noticed in the bill, and I very much like the intent of this bill, but in reading the substitute yesterday that was adopted it says on line 22 i'm sorry line 23 household member or intimate partner i'd ask the senator what it what does intimate partner means in this bill senator from mecklenburg thank you madam president intimate partner to my knowledge is someone you're in a dating relationship with that you may not

[01:52:17] have a child. Madam President. Senator from King George. Is intimate, I would ask the, I'm sorry, would the senator yield for another question? Will the senator yield? Yes, Madam President, I'll yield. Senator has the floor. I'll ask it this way, is intimate partner defined in this bill or would that be left up to speculation by others? Senator from Mecklenburg. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:52:47] since i'm not a lawyer i don't see that it is defined in the bill but i'll defer to another attorney who seems to be sitting behind you and the gentleman from rockingham can answer that question and um to my colleague the senator from king george king george since i'm not an attorney i would have loved for you to ask me this question at caucus thank you senator from rockingham Madam Chairman, Madam President, I think Senator from Rockingham has the floor.

[01:53:26] Madam President, I think the Senator from Mecklenburg yielded to me to maybe respond to Senator from King George's question. And the best I can do is say that Senator from Loudon had a bill that defines intimate partner and adds the definition of intimate partner to the definition of family or household member contained in 16.1-228.

[01:54:01] If that bill passes both chambers and is signed by the governor, then intimate partner is a defined term under the definition of family or household member contained in the bill. I think that that may have been added in the floor amendment. I can't remember whether it was or not, but I would tell Senator from King George that depending on what happens with the bill from the Senator from Loudoun, it will be a defined term. If that bill does

[01:54:35] not pass then yeah there could be a problem and it may require some additional surgery does the senator from king george wish to speak i think he answered my question if i understood it correctly it is not defined in this bill and it would be contingent upon another bill passing actually i would ask the gentleman one last question if he would yield senator will you yield i yield senator has the floor. Then I'd ask the senator from Rockingham, how in fact is intimate partner

[01:55:09] defined in the other bill that we hope is going to pass so this bill could rely on the definition of that bill? Madam President, I yield to the senator from Loudon. The senator from Loudon, will you yield? Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I assume that he means me and not the other senator from Loudon, but I'll stand up. The definition is intimate partner madam president um i'm sorry madam president i yield senator has the floor madam president um the definition of intimate partner is in the boyfriend loophole bill and we modeled that

[01:55:46] after the federal legislation the federal bill that passed and the definition of intimate partner at the federal level and we included it in 161228 um which is the the definitional section out of 16.1 that that part of the code and that's where it would go um in in the code but it's modeled after the federal legislation closing the boyfriend loophole um and the stalking language out of the federal code thank you madam i thank the senators madam president madam president senator from mecklenburg um i can answer what that for what purpose sorry madam president i have an answer

[01:56:21] to the gentleman's question about what an intimate partner is senator has the floor in um in the um Gentle lady from Loudoun's legislation, Senate Bill 160, an intimate partner, means an individual who, within the previous 12 months, was in a romantic, dating, or sexual relationship with the person as determined by the length, nature, frequency, and type of interaction between the individuals involved in the relationship.

[01:56:54] If I can ask the gentleman from Rockingham if that is a suitable answer to his question. Senator, do you mean the senator from King George? I'm sorry, the senator from King George. Senator from King George, do you yield for that question?

[01:57:12] Yes, Madam President, I yield. And I think the question was, do I find that to be a suitable answer? Madam President, it concerns me that we are passing legislation that could result in people being charged with and or convicted of felonies and or misdemeanors.

[01:57:33] And the definition of a very critical part of that is not in this bill, but it's in another bill that has yet to pass this body and been signed by the governor. So I appreciate the senator's answer, but it concerns me.

[01:57:50] Madam President, can I ask that this bill go by temporarily? Without objection, Senate Bill 673 goes by temporarily. Bill 688, a bill relating to campaign finance, campaign contribution limits, contingency.

[01:58:24] The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. I'm sorry. I moved the bill. Passed and speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, Senate Bill 688 is another one that got a lot of discussion yesterday when we were talking about some floor amendments that I made.

[01:58:45] But the bill is basically a campaign finance trigger law. It basically would enact restrictions on campaign finance, but only in the event Citizens United ends up not being the law of the land. And I would

just note that can either happen either by the Supreme Court changing its mind or if we were to pass the constitutional amendment.

[01:59:01] But from my perspective, what this does is focuses the conversation on where it should be, which is on Citizens United, because until that abomination of a case is not the law of the land anymore, it is basically impossible to regulate campaign finance in any kind of meaningful way. And this bill basically sends the message, I think, that we support getting rid of that case.

[01:59:21] And if they do, that we support putting caps in place. But until then, it won't be the right time because anything we do is completely meaningless given the current state of law in this country. I'd hope we could pass the bill.

[01:59:41] Senator from King George. Would the Senator from Eastern Fairfax yield for a question? Senator, will you yield? I yield. Senator from King George. And I apologize, but somebody's got to ask these questions. So I would ask the senator from Eastern Fairfax, is this bill also contingent upon what happens somewhere else in the future sometime?

[02:00:03] Madam President, what I would say to the senator is that this is a trigger law, and I basically stole the idea from the anti-abortion community, who passed anti-abortion laws all over the country in the event that Roe v. Wade got repealed, and I thought that was such a good idea that we could use it in this situation as well.

[02:00:20] Senator from King George. Would the gentleman yield for another question? Will the gentleman yield? Would the gentleman stop talking like a lawyer and just say yes or no, please? Senator from Eastern Fairfax, do you wish to answer that question?

[02:00:36] I only give my clients that advice. I don't take it myself. The question is, shall Senate Bill 688 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[02:00:52] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[02:01:08] Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 688 passes. Senate Bill 2, a bill relating to paid family and medical leave insurance programs, notice requirements, civil action.

[02:01:28] The senator from Northern Fairfax. Madam President, I move the bill pass. I'm speaking to the bill. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. president this is a paid family medical leave insurance program that we will be embarking on organizing over the next three years um it has passed numerous times in this body and has uh passed the house in the senate twice and been vetoed by the previous governor um it is a work in progress uh the house has its own version it will be coming over here i understand and have had

[02:02:07] some conversations with the the senator from mecklenburg we will continue to work diligently to make sure that we get it right but basically this is a an insurance program that will be funded through individual contributions um and i move the bill pass the senator from hanover thank you madam president madam president rise to speak to the bill the senator has the floor madam president But I'd like to thank the senator.

[02:02:40] I know that this has been something that she and I have discussed. I know that particularly the last few days have been particularly difficult for her. And there is no question that she feels deeply for

people and her heart is in the right place.

[02:02:59] And so we had a good conversation about that. Madam President we also had a conversation and specifically this bill the way it is written I do not think it's the intent of the senator for it to be this way but it does leave out a few things. State employees that are part-time are not covered and the reason that is is because in the Code of Virginia the Personnel Act we determine that certain employees are covered under the Personnel Act. Those employees are not hourly employees and they are not

[02:03:37] currently university employees. So that would mean the employees at universities and hourly employees are not covered because we use employees by the Compensation Act. Madam President, I would also say that the state plan for the employees that are covered are different than what the private sector would be required to do. For example, the time frame for the state plan only is eight weeks and it only is for families that are having children. So parents that

[02:04:14] have children, they are able to take that time away from work. For the state plan to be the same as what we're requiring the private sector, it would have to have additional code section changes and you might remember yesterday I asked to see what those code section changes would be it got sent down in the form of amendment which I was not trying to offer but those are some of the changes that would happen have to happen statutorily so there are some things that the private sector is going to be required to do under this bill

[02:04:50] that the government employees are not going to be covered again I think that the senator intends them to be covered, wants them to be covered, and she has indicated to me individually that she is going to try to work those through.

[02:05:07] But Madam President, where we have a fundamental different view is this is a tax on employees. Make no mistake, they are going to have to pay this tax. The program at the lowest levels indicates that it's going to cost $116 million to stand up the administrative cost and then about 1.4 billion dollars a year. Well that 1.4 billion doesn't come out of the air. It comes from two places. It comes

[02:05:39] from employees and employers. Now the way the bill is written, it's split. So the employer will pay half and the employee will pay half. Now Madam President, I have heard some numbers bantered about about what that could potentially be. But Madam President, I'd like to look at what it is actually in other states.

[02:06:06] Washington State has a similar program. The tax that they had on the program last year was not enough to cover the expenses. It had to be increased 57% from 25 to this year, 26.

[02:06:24] So their tax is now 1.13% of an employee's salary. that is split between the employer and the employee. In Virginia, the average employee salary is a little over $70,000. So you can do the math that that will be upwards of $500 per employee and $500 per employer. So Madam President, I realize that some private sector

[02:06:56] groups do this. We do it in state employees for certain sectors, but make no mistake, this is going to cost Virginians more money. It's gonna cost employees more money, and it's gonna cost employers more money.

[02:07:13] And I understand the estimates are about 1.4 billion. I think the experiences in other states should show us that's not the case, that it's going to be significantly more expensive. And Madam

President, I would also say, right now under this bill, there's no cap.

[02:07:34] So if more employees decide to opt into using this program, there's no limit on what that cost is on the employer and employee. There's no cap on this number. So I believe that it will be a minimum of 1.13% on an employee's income, like it is in Washington State.

[02:07:56] Could be more. And there's no limit to what that can do going up. So as we look at what the expense is and we talk about affordability, there's certainly some benefits to this program. But employees and employers are going to pay.

[02:08:15] They're going to pay a tax to get it. This is not free. This is going to cost people. And this is going to cost people money out of their paycheck, whether they use the program or do not use the program. So, Madam President, I just want to end.

[02:08:33] This is a, Senator and I had a very good conversation about how we can look at the world and want to care for people and it be different. This is one of those situations where we have a different view. I believe that employees should have that money in their pocket to make the decision of how they want to do it.

[02:08:57] If their employer wants to raise their salary on that average $1,000, that should be the decision. If an employee wants to purchase insurance with that money, that should be their decision. Us forcing a tax, I mean, that comes out of everybody's pocket, and there's no way that costs do not go up as a result of adding that burden onto the system.

[02:09:24] So we can view the world differently on that, but make no mistake, this is a tax on employees and employers, and it will cost Virginians more money. The Senator from Arlington.

[02:09:41] you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise to speak in favor of the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I guess perhaps there is a philosophical disagreement on how we should treat employees, what kind of workplace we should offer, and what kind of environment we want to create for our workers and our families. There is a cost to the employee if an employee needs to stay home to care for a newborn, or an adopted child, or a sick parent. That's a cost. And to not

[02:10:18] have the safety net under them where part of their salary is replaced while they're home doing this very critical family support effort, it makes it nearly impossible for somebody to make a good decision for somebody to decide okay perhaps I cannot pay my rent or forfeit a prescription because I'm not gonna get paid leave while I stay home and take care of again my child a sick parent a sick family member this is we're trying

[02:10:54] to create a system that adjusts to real life to the to the issues that each one of us faces has a human being as a mother daughter sister father son brother we're all in this environment where we have to make choices and and we have to balance work life with family obligations that's what this bill enables us to do yes there is a cost but i would argue it is a much smaller cost than if somebody has to go out and pay for child care or pay for home health care

[02:11:29] because they can't be there themselves 12 states have implemented this nearly every western civilized uh foreign country in the world has a form of paid family leave we're behind the eight ball we're we're the ones that are holding out because in some sectors we're i think evaluating the cost and not

understanding the value of what's being presented. There's also several reenactment clauses in this bill. Regulations will be issued. There are some phase-in options.

[02:12:09] If state employees are already receiving something generous, more generous than what this bill provides, they're not going to lose those benefits. There are some guardrails in here. This is time. It is time to move forward. For everybody who's ever talked about family values, this is the bill that will enable you to vote for family values. Thank you, Madam President.

[02:12:39] The Senator from Prince Edward. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Madam President, I think I'm probably one of the only members of this body that has lived on every side of this issue. From starting my life at very, very humble beginnings, spending the vast majority of my life living paycheck to paycheck as a single income in our home.

[02:13:05] To finding a way to scratch out a few hundred bucks and start a business and then to go on to have a lot of employees of my own. And Madam President, I understand the intent of this and the intent of this is coming from the goodness of our hearts. But when we think that as legislators we have goodness in our hearts, but our employers don't, I believe we're mistaken.

[02:13:27] We care about each other. A lot of businesses that are started are started because people care about their community, not in spite of it. And the consequences of legislation that feel good but that doesn't reconcile with reality are substantial.

[02:13:44] And the thing that we're doing right now in this country, we've been doing it for the past 50 years at least, and we're continuing to do it, is we're making the wall of regulation and the wall of burden higher and higher and higher on small businesses. Large businesses compete really hard for labor.

[02:14:02] Very large businesses that can afford these kind of policies, the kind of businesses that frankly are large enough to consolidate enough power to farm us, not as customers, but as sources of revenue, they can afford these kinds of policies. What this is going to hit is the small business that's trying to connect the ladder of opportunity that used to go to the ground floor that's trying to get on that ladder and climb up and create wealth, not just for their communities, but also for their families.

[02:14:34] So I understand the intent of it, but the reality is that the businesses this is gonna hurt the most are the businesses that we desperately need. When we don't have a fresh supply of small businesses that are coming in, that are putting downward pressure on price, upward pressure on service, And keeping these big businesses in check and keeping them honest, we get this continued roll-up of power and money and monopolization.

[02:15:00] We saw a huge roll-up of that during COVID. And I would just like to say that I personally, again, while I understand this, we look out for each other in my companies. We just look out for each other. We cover when someone needs to be out. We just take care of that. So I understand it.

[02:15:16] I think the intentions are good. I think as a body, there's a lot that we can do to help foster the growth of small business and to stop creating all of the advantage for the big guys. And I believe this is policy that, in spite of its well-intended founding, is just going to create advantages for the big guys.

[02:15:38] Thank you. The Senator from Western Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I would like to speak to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. rightfully we have members both sides of the aisle who are debating and getting into the merits of the bill one way

or the other and I think that's the obligation of the body is to make sure the words are right and I also want to take a zoom out too because I heard one of the senators mention things that happen in other states with this and rightfully so we should be looking at what's happened across the country I'll just tell you a story from a not our direct neighbor state but a Delmarva neighbor over in Delaware a friend of

[02:16:17] mine more than a decade ago. She had a rooftop wedding where she stood in a white dress. She leaned over and her husband-to-be sat in his tuxedo. And when I say sat, he was in a wheelchair and he had a breathing tube in his nose. And they had their vows there days before he died.

[02:16:41] And she became a widow at 24. The amount of time and effort and the amount of love that she had to have to power through all the care that he needed as his body gave up on him even when his mind didn't. It spoke to why it is that we have bills like this in the first place because she was one of the lucky ones who could take paid time off to care and she used that experience that she had

[02:17:18] to inform her number one priority when she ran for the state senate in Delaware which is paid family medical leave and got it done. And now she represents the whole state in Congress. And so I look at this today. I think back about that story. I think about why we do this in the first place. Why are we going to bat for this? If anyone here was ever in a position where someone who you loved, where someone who was your family, where someone who needed you couldn't have you

[02:17:55] being present the way that you needed to be for them simply because you couldn't get time off because someone couldn't afford it. That's what we're trying to deal with. That's what we're trying to deal with. No one should have that heartbreak. No one should suffer like that with that uncertainty and that cloud of how am I going to afford this? How am I going to make this work? All of us in this room have been affected by family tragedies, I have to imagine at some point or another. All of us have to deal with health issues of loved ones and others and I hope

[02:18:32] we remember that as we go to cast our votes today about the very real impact and yeah businesses are going to have to adjust and we heard some concerns coming out about employees and others. I understand where those are and I don't think any of them are unfounded and at the same time the alternative is not doing this because this is what's on the table today. This is the only game in town. It has taken us a long, long, long time to get here. This is only my ninth session in the General Assembly, and some members here have served much longer, but think about the effort that has gone

[02:19:08] in year after year after year to try to eventually get this right. Today's the day. Today's the day where we try and we do our absolute best to get this right. And this is, of course, a living document. Of course, things can be changed between now and time it goes to the House, And of course, things can be changed from the time it goes from the General Assembly to the governor.

[02:19:29] Of course, it is still a work in progress. And let's not let any perceived issue that can be resolved be what gets in the way of the next family who needs that time to take care of someone who is in a crisis of a lifetime.

[02:19:51] Thank you, Madam President. Does the Senator from Prince Edward wish to speak a second time? Yes, yes, Madam President. Thank you. I just want to add some context. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I tried to pull these numbers up before, but it took a minute. It just, since I started my business in 2009, small businesses have lost about 23% of the total share of business revenue

from 2009 until today in 2025. Small businesses have lost about 23%. I can tell you I have watched since the day I started my business until now.

[02:20:27] watch the regulation get get put more and more and more of a chokehold on the environment that we're trying to survive in so I just wanted to add some data to support my my comments from earlier thank you the senator from northern Fairfax madam president if if no one else is waiting to speak I'd like to senator has the floor thank you madam president I wasn't gonna go through my whole spiel but I will now because I want to clarify and make sure that my colleagues understand that this is a well vetted data-driven piece of work as I

[02:21:03] said I've been working on this for eight years with the folks who have done this in other areas in other parts of the country where successful programs are in place there are 13 other states and the District of Columbia and many of them have success stories giving employees and employers the grace and the ability to take care of their employees when the best things happen like bringing a child home or the worst thing happens when your child has cancer when you have cancer when you are dealing with the death of a loved one most people in here know that i'm dealing with the death of a loved one right now

[02:21:42] and i can tell you that you don't need you shouldn't be making big decisions at a time when you have a personal crisis you need to have that grace and we know that while there's a family Medical Leave Act, a federal program. It offers 12 weeks of unprotected, job protected, unpaid leave. That's very limited because most people, 56% of the population of Virginia, can't afford to make that decision to take the time off

[02:22:16] because they can't put food on their on their table. In Virginia, 67% of Latin Latinos and 57% of black workers respectively are either ineligible or or can't afford to take unpaid leave through the protections of fmla and scenarios like this they either fail to care for their loved ones or they quit their jobs or they end up in dire consequences we don't have to do it like that right this would establish a paid family leave

[02:22:53] program it is an insurance program that would be just like every other insurance program the adjusters look and they do actuarial studies in other states it has been one half of one percent where they have done their due diligence and that's like if you make fifty thousand dollars a year we're talking five dollars a week okay cup coffee we're talking about and under my program that I have developed that we have developed over the past eight years if you are a small business ten

[02:23:28] employees are under the employer has no responsibility to pay any of the premiums because I agree we don't want to burden the small businesses who want to take care of their employees when hard times come or when the best times come and you're correct that the big companies can do this and they're already doing this this is this is something that is happening in other parts of the world. And we know that young people today are delaying having children and starting

[02:24:01] their families because they can't make it work. I remember when I was a young mom, I was making $27,000 a year, I think. And I quit my job because we couldn't afford daycare. And then when I had my second daughter, I ended up with one of those terrible, terrible, life-threatening diseases and had to give birth to her two months early. I had a c-section. I had a toddler at home. My husband only got two weeks off because he was working for one of the tech companies that rewarded you for

[02:24:35] working until, you know, for any other cost. And so somehow I had to handle my toddler and somehow get to 20 miles away to where my daughter was in the hospital for six weeks while I was still sick with no family around. And I almost lost it, right? Like, I mean, it was an impossible situation.

[02:25:04] And my husband couldn't afford for him to skip another month or two months. We didn't have that option. There are people who have these issues facing them every single day. And yes, it is my intention to cover everyone in the Commonwealth. People who are self-employed will have the option to pay into this themselves and pay both the employee and the employer coverage again this has been worked through with the people who have done this in every other state the governor who

[02:25:41] has made this a very high priority is working with us to make sure as we go through the process that if there is an inadvertent error that is in the drafting and i know that there are some drafting errors here, that we fix it before she signs it into law. But today we have the power to give families the grace and the confidence to know that they're not going to have to face an impossible decision. When their child has cancer and they can't work it out to be with their kid to take

[02:26:18] care of them, when they're with somebody at the end of their life or they've just experienced a devastating loss and they can't even understand what someone's saying to them because their brains all scrambled we need to be able to give people the grace because we're humans first we are humans first and if we can't remember that we work to take care of our families we're not working because every job is fabulous and we want to make sure that the company while we want them all to be

[02:26:52] successful is the end of all you know what are we doing so I move that we pass the bill the question is shall Senate bill 2 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll it's 21 nose 19 eyes 21 nose 19 Senate bill 2

[02:27:29] passes. Senate Bill 21, a bill to direct the office of the Secretary of Public Safety and Homeland Security and the office of the Secretary of Health and Human Resources to convene a stakeholder workgroup to submit a plan and recommended timeline for transferring responsibility for the Department of Juvenile Justice. The Senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I move the Senate Bill 21 pass. I'm speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Senate Bill Bill 21 is, as stated by the clerk, is a Section 1 bill that directs the Office of the Secretary

[02:28:06] of Public Safety and Homeland Security and the Office of the Secretary of Health and Human Resources to convene a stakeholder work group to create a plan and recommend a timeline for transfer and responsibility for the Department of Juvenile Justice from the Secretary of Public Safety and Homeland Security to the Secretary of Health and Human Resources.

[02:28:24] And with that explanation, I move that the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 21 pass? All in favor of that, all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[02:28:41] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, noes 18. Ayes 22, noes 18. Senate Bill 21 passes.

[02:28:58] Bill 72, a bill to reduce hearing-related, heating-related cost of living for low-income residents by requiring certain electric utilities to provide energy efficiency upgrades report. The junior senator from Loudoun.

[02:29:15] Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass. I'm speaking to that motion. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 72 directs Phase 1 and Phase 2 electric utilities to make best reasonable efforts to deliver targeted energy efficiency upgrades to at least 30% of low-income households by 2031, focusing on families with the highest heating cost burdens and reducing reliance on more expensive heating options.

[02:29:43] All measures are subject to the SEC oversight. They are required to be in the public interest and must be supported by credible energy savings data. With an estimated savings of $600 to $1,400 annually for eligible households, Madam President, this is a practical step toward lowering costs for some of our most vulnerable constituents.

[02:30:05] I hope it's a will of the body to adopt this bill. Thank you. The question is, shall Senate Bill 72 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[02:30:21] Have all the senators voted? any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 72 passes. Senate Bill 191. A bill relating to railroad safety, minimum train crew, movement of freight, civil liberties, civil penalties. Senator from Norfolk. Thank You Madam President. I move that the bill pass and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Madam President, SB 191

[02:30:59] as reflected in the substitute adopted by commerce and labor establishes a clear minimum safety standard for the movement of freight trains in the commonwealth the substitute creates new subsection 56-425.1 and requires that any train locomotive or light engine used in connection with the movement of freight operate with a crew of at least two qualified individuals it expressly exempts hostler and utility service operations recognizing the operational distinctions in rail yards this legislation reflects long-standing industry practice freight operations typically

[02:31:39] involve both an engineer and a conductor whose roles are distinct and essential to safety in emergency situations including derailments mechanical failures or blocked crossings having two trained crew members enables coordination communication and rapid response this bill also places prior in for also replaces prior enforcement provisions with a transparency measure the state corporation commission will include it in its annual report to the governor

[02:32:13] the number of probable violations of applicable federal crew related safety standards that were investigated and referred to the Federal Railroad Administration, and it also removes any penalties. SB 191 is about public safety, operational clarity, and responsible oversight. And with that, Madam President, I renew my motion that the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 191 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to

[02:32:47] vote. Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 20. Noes, 20. The chair votes aye. Senate Bill 191 passes. I was, I was told. Senator from Eastern Fairfax, I did that for you, but I

[02:33:27] do not have to do that. I will not do that going forward, Senator. Senate Bill 199 a bill relating to employment and paid sick leave civil penalties. Senator from Arlington. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move that Senate bill 199 pass and speaking to that motion. The Senator has the floor.

[02:33:59] Thank you Madam President. This is a paid sick day bill. What the bill does is it It requires for every 30 hours of work, an employee would earn one hour of paid sick leave.

[02:34:16] It would be capped at 40 hours for 12 months. So no more than five full days in a 12-month period. There is a phase-in period for this. starting July 1, 2027, 50 or more employers with 50 more employees would have to offer this paid sick leave. January 1, 2028, employers with 25 or more employees. In January 1, 2029, everybody else

[02:34:48] would be picked up. Local governments would have to implement this by July 1, 2028. There is a uh enactment clause that uh requires the state department of health and human resources to actually look or or um to actually evaluate the impact of this provision on state employees what changes would need to be made and uh report back to the general assembly um i said hhr i meant the

[02:35:22] Human Resource Management Department. The bill does have a private right of action, but there is an opportunity for an employer to correct any mistakes that may have been made in calculating an employee's leave. And there is an exemption for health care workers who work on average less than 30 hours a week. And we also exempt the UVA health system and the VCU health system.

[02:35:53] this bill has been worked on for this is my third year carrying it we've had many stakeholders involved it's been heard both by commerce and labor and of course by finance it is my wish that the body passed this bill thank you the question is shall Senate bill 199 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close

[02:36:32] the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate bill 199 passes. Senate bill 200. A bill relating to the Board of Education, standards of learning assessments, and related assessment methods. Development, administration, scoring, and release. The Senator from Western Henrico.

[02:37:01] - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move passage of Senate Bill 200 and speaking to that motion. - Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, this is building off of a bill from last year and it's largely clean up, cleaning up language around special education, giving the school boards a little bit more flexibility around the testing in the last two weeks.

[02:37:19] The one big substantive thing it does is get rid of the through growth assessments in elementary school, which a lot of your elementary schools and teachers really do not like. so we're getting rid of it. So I move passage. The question is, shall Senate Bill 200 pass?

[02:37:37] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. Senate Bill 200 passes.

[02:38:00] Senate Bill 209, a bill relating to conditional release of geriatric prisoners. The senior senator from Virginia Beach. Madam President, I move the bill to pass. Speaking to that.

[02:38:17] Senator has the floor. Madam President, members, this bill we discussed yesterday when we did the substitute. And again, I want to thank the senator from Richmond, the gentleman from Richmond City, for his assistance with tightening this bill up. What this does is tightens up geriatric release for only the most heinous crimes out there.

[02:38:42] I'm happy to answer questions or go on forever, but I think everybody's pretty familiar with this bill at this point in time. And with that, I move this bill to pass. Thank you. The senator from Hampton. Madam President, I would ask if the senior senator from Virginia Beach would yield for a question.

[02:39:00] Senator, will you yield? President, happy to yield. Senator from Hampton. Madam President I would ask the senior senator if he's aware of a $360,000 fiscal impact on this bill. Senator from Virginia Beach. Sorry Madam President I'm trying to read the transcript. Madam President I am not because I believe when I presented this last there was no financial impact in the system but I've not checked it since I think yesterday or the day before but I'm happy to take a

[02:39:39] look at it senator from Hampton additional question madam president will the senator yield madam president I'm happy to yield senator from Hampton given that he is unaware of the fiscal impact I assume that there is no budget amendment for three hundred and sixty thousand dollars for this senator from Virginia Beach madam president I believe I did put up I'm sorry answering the gentle lady from Hampton I believe I did put in a budget request or a budget yeah budget request for this and I believe if I'm not

[02:40:15] mistaken I estimated it to be a million dollars if I'm not mistaken not knowing at the time if it would be required or not I know there was I'm looking now there looks like there's five budget impact statements senator from Hampton speaking to the bill senator has the floor madam president I understand that Sometimes fiscal impact statements come in late on legislation,

[02:40:54] and I do not see a budget request with regard to this particular piece of legislation. Madam Chair. Senator from Charlottesville. Given the fiscal impact of this bill, I'd make a motion that we refer this to the Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[02:41:16] Madam President, if I may. Senior Senator from Virginia Beach. Madam President, I'm looking at the budget impact that hit yesterday. and it says according to the parole board there is no anticipated fiscal impact as a result of the bill any unanticipated cost that may arise from the bill are expected to be covered within existing resources and this is the one that was put up yesterday which has department of corrections 2027 360 000 again it says there is according to the parole board there is no anticipated fiscal impact as a result of the bill any anticipated costs that may arise from the bill

[02:41:55] are expected to be covered with existing resources. Senator, we have a motion on the floor to re-refer the bill to the Senate Committee on Finance and Appropriations.

[02:42:12] The question is, shall Senate Bill 209 be re-referred to the Committee on Finance and Appropriations? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. No.

[02:42:27] The chair is not certain this will be a recorded vote. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote?

[02:42:44] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 19. Ayes 20, noes 19.

[02:43:01] The bill is re-referred to the Senate Committee on Finance and Appropriations. Senate Bill 220, a bill relating to high school students, athletes, eligibility, enrollment.

[02:43:19] The Senator from Richmond City. Madam President, I move the bill pass. And speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 220 simply directs the Virginia

Department of Education to work with VHSL to review residency rules for high school student athletes to examine whether or not VHSL residency requirements for athletic participation align with public school enrollment residency requirements in Virginia.

[02:43:49] I'm just of the position, Madam President, that if a school and a school district allows a student to attend school there, they should be able to participate in any and all the activities that the school provides. And with that, I ask that the bill will pass. - The question is, shall Senate Bill 220 pass?

[02:44:09] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[02:44:27] - Ayes 39, no zero. - Ayes 39, no zero. Senate Bill 220 passes. - Senate Bill 230, a bill relating to expungement of police and court records. - The senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[02:44:44] Thank you, Madam President. Move the bill to pass. And speaking to the bill. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This bill formally did a whole bunch of really good stuff, but some people thought it cost too much money. So basically, the bill became a bill to study doing a bunch of good stuff.

[02:45:01] And we'll find out how much it really costs sometimes next year. But basically, the bill looks at reforming a whole bunch of bad cases on expungement and allowing people to expunge lesser included offenses of um greater greater included offenses if they plead guilty to a lesser included offense but all that got nuked because just to reenact my clause with a study so if you want to study ways to enhance expungement vote green if you like expungement the way it is i guess vote red the question is shall senate bill 230 pass all in favor of that motion will record

[02:45:40] their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 27, noes 12. Ayes 27, noes 12. Senate Bill 230 passes. Senate Bill 253, a bill relating to electric utilities pilot program for energy assistance and weatherization for certain individuals, cost recovery for certain

[02:46:18] electrical facilities. The senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, thank you, Madam President. Madam president senate bill 253 first of all let me move to the bill pass and then speaking to the bill senator has the floor yes madam president my voice is gone what senate bill 253 does it uh can't see my own paper yes president senator from eastern fairfax speaking to the motion

[02:46:57] senator has the floor thank you madam president this bill was a recommendation of the commission on electrical utility regulation it extends up what was a pilot program for energy assistance and weatherization at the time we adopted that program we also adopted language uh sort of reinforcing the strategic undergrounding program and so we also extend that in this bill i think to 2028 uh also in senate finance committee uh we adopted amendments proposed by i'm sorry in commerce and labor committee we adopted amendments proposed by senator lucas

[02:47:32] that allowed electrical utilities to cover costs created by data center hookups before the data centers are turned online the net impact of that on bills is to save rate payers i think it was either i think it was five dollars a month and i have actually have the numbers here and so if you want to talk about saving people some money um due to the impacts that the data centers are having this will this will be a little bit

of that the data centers will then help once they turn them on help cover those costs but before they're turned on sometimes their expenses associated

[02:48:10] with constructing the infrastructure that aren't picked up until they turn them on but that's basically what this bill does it does three things it's a good affordability bill the senator from king george speaking to the bill madam president senator has the floor um madam president i want to thank the patron for this um for quite a few years now i've been standing on this floor and in committee asking this General Assembly to require the data centers to pay for some of the cost that they are imposing on our citizens and this one of the first bills I've seen and I appreciate that I wish we could take it a little

[02:48:50] farther and maybe next year but at least now the data centers will have to absorb some of those costs that up to this point have been going to all the ratepayers in Virginia. And I felt like that was very unfair. So I thank the Senator from Portsmouth for bringing this bill and hope we can keep moving forward on this issue. The Senator from Hanover.

[02:49:18] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor. Madam President, I appreciate the Senator from Western Fairfax explanation of Eastern Fairfax um explanation of the bill and i think he did a accurate uh general explanation that this bill has three things weatherization cost of hooking up data centers to the grid and strategic undergrounding i just want to make sure that we're all clear as this bill went through it became

[02:49:54] apparent that I think the strategic undergrounding goes through 33, 2033 was the date, it was originally 38, moved to 33, but the there's cost savings to bill payers, people who have energy bills and pay from the data center sections, and there are cost expenses to ratepayers for the strategic undergrounding.

[02:50:18] Strategic undergrounding in a number of places is very beneficial, but this This does take away the State Corporation Commission's ability to look at a project and make a determination about whether the cost-benefit analysis is there.

[02:50:35] This is the legislature making the decision for. So with those, it's kind of a wash. But I agree with the senator from King George and the senator from Eastern Fairfax and the senator from Portsmouth that this bill should be moved forward and is a positive step in a number of different directions.

[02:50:54] The question is, shall Senate Bill 253 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[02:51:15] Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. Senate Bill 253 passes. Senate Bill 256, a bill relating to appliance, minimum energy and water conservation standards, heating, ventilation and air conditioning facilities and home appliances, Department of Energy prohibited practices penalty.

[02:51:48] The senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Move the bill pass and speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This is the bill that is provides a backstop from any federal policy changes in regards to energy standards for appliances and so if there's a rollback of the federal standards it sort of freezes in place the current federal standards for appliances moving forward we know that it takes a lot for manufacturers to retool the entire manufacturing line we want to keep these standards in place and appreciate the body's passage of the measure. The question is shall

[02:52:24] Senate bill 256 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll I was 21 knows 19 eyes 21 knows 19 Senate bill 256 passes Senate bill 283 a bill relating to penalties for failure to appear contempt the senator from Eastern Thank you so much, Madam President.

[02:52:56] I move this bill move forward and I'd like to speak to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you so much, Madam President. This legislation is regarding failure to appear after the substitute that we have adopted out of the courts committee. This is extremely scaled down.

[02:53:12] This version of the legislation simply changes the definition of willfully fails to appear to clarify that for the failure to appear charged to be given uh there must be um an indication of an intentional avoidance of courts uh no hardships or mistakes and so it spells out a few of the mitigating factors like illness transportation or child care challenges for the court to consider but ultimately the substitute that's now before us maintains accountability while also trying to seek some balance of fairness for those individuals who have a legitimate reason for not appearing and so I'm hoping that again we can move this legislation

[02:53:51] forward the question is shall Senate bill 283 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 21 nose 19 eyes 21 nose 19 Senate bill 283 passes

[02:54:22] Senate bill 334 a bill relating to conveyances of interest in real property public hearing required. The senator from Western Prince William. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move the bill passed and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Alright thank you Madam President. Madam President yesterday I received some constructive feedback to give my a little bit more of an explanation about certain bills as I'm looking at a certain senator from the southwest delegation right now. So I'm gonna go ahead and do that so there's confusion about what this bill is so what this bill says is that no locality when they go to

[02:55:01] dispose of public property here shall basically do that uh without holding a public hearing first so what does it say no locality shall sell at public or private sale exchange lease as lesser mortgage pledged subordinate interest in or otherwise dispose of any permanent easements or right-of-ways for the construction of one, new electric transmission lines or distribution facilities of more than 69 kVs, two, data center operations for supporting electric transmission or distribution facilities of more than 69 kVs, or three, any commercial or industrial facility that requires electric service through electric transmission or distribution facilities

[02:55:40] described in clause one, unless a public hearing is first held in accordance with the notice and hearing requirements set forth in 15.2-2204. No provision of this subdivision shall apply to the disposition of an easement or right-of-way for the purpose of maintenance or replacement of existing facilities.

[02:55:58] Finally, such public hearings shall include a disclosure of the proposed use, any anticipated impacts to the community and environment, and any alternative locations considered by the governing body. No vote on any action intended to dispose of any real property interest may be taken until a public hearing has been held.

[02:56:15] Madam President, this bill came to me directly from the Bristow community in Bristow in my district after there was a proposal for an above ground transmission line in the community that would

wipe out a significant amount of wooded space in between people's homes. Back in December we had hundreds of people on a 24 degree Saturday morning coming out to march in protest about what was going on. This is one of the actions that came directly from a request from the community for us to take it's good and with that I motion I've renewed motion to pass the bill the

[02:56:54] question is shall Senate bill 334 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll as 26 news 14 eyes 26 nose 14 Senate bill 334 passes senate bill 339 a bill to direct the state corporation commission to conduct proceedings

[02:57:28] to review cost allocation among different customer classifications for certain electric utilities the senior senator from loudon thank you madam president madam president i move the bill pass in speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president madam president this bill um seeks to build on work that um this body passed last year um a senate bill that i had that I'm losing the number of in my head right now, but what it did was ask the SEC to look at rate cases and make sure that our highest energy users were looking at whether or not we needed to have a different rate for them. The SEC did that with a rate case in December. This bill, in that rate

[02:58:05] case though they did not look at additional costs like transmission costs that are being created by these high energy users uh in 20 uh the the projection for 2024 through 2031 we think that'll be more than 2.4 billion dollars so it is a significant number and so this um directs asked the sec to look at those transmission costs as well in their next rate case it also does a second thing which um uh directs uh dominion to in their next rate case look at as one of the um generation costs that they propose that they provide to the SEC they include

[02:58:45] probability of dispatch which is by most expert witnesses identified as the most fair method of determining among different alternatives of assigning who is responsible for the generation cost of energy and electricity. Madam President with that I move the bill pass. The question is shall Senate bill 339 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the Senators ready to vote. Have all the Senators voted. Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0.

[02:59:19] Ayes 40, noes 0. Senate Bill 339 passes. Senate Bill 375 relating to the Commonwealth Savers Plan, Virginia College Opportunity Endowment and Fund Established report. The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. I move the bill pass and speaking of that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, Senate Bill 375 relates to the problem that I've been working on now. I told somebody the other day, I've been working on it for three years. They said, no, you've been working on it

[02:59:56] for five. And so I finally got this bill on the floor. It took a while. But what it has to do with is the Virginia 529 plan has a surplus. I read about this after a JLARC did a study about five years ago. And they basically have an actuarial surplus of about $1.5 billion. That's generated in part from two things. One is excess monies left over from tuition contracts for a bunch of different reasons. And the other piece is management fees that Virginia has earned

[03:00:32] because Virginia has one of the largest 529 plans in America. We started it really early on when the plant when congress passed the section 529 back in 1994 and so basically what my idea was to take the money throw it in endowment fund take the earnings every year and then use it to provide scholarships to

folks um the finance committee took it and basically made some changes to it and basically under the what the finance committee did the bill um we're going to take out um a slug of money that a committee i think consulting with jay lark's going to figure out i think right now 529 set aside 500 million dollars they think there could be some more money set aside right now

[03:01:11] ultimately there'll probably be something north of a billion they want to put it in a fund called the opportunity fund and then use that fund to provide a mix of scholarships financial aid and other programs to enhance educational access to low-income students that's basically what the version that came out of senate finance is it's a bit different from what i proposed but uh it's progress on this problem we've had this billion and a half dollars sitting in a bank account doing nothing for five years and this allows us to do something with it so madam madam president I'd hope we could pass this bill along the other side continue the dialogue I'm not sure how much of a fan

[03:01:50] the other side is about doing anything on this right now but we need to do something because there's no point leaving a billion and a half dollars just laying around doing nothing so I hope we could pass this bill to create

[03:02:00] more educational opportunity in higher ed for folks the question is shall Senate Senate Bill 375 pass. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those

[03:02:37] opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll.

[03:02:55] Ayes 38, noes 2. Ayes 38, noes 2. Senate Bill 375 passes. Senate Bill 378, a bill relating to collective bargaining by public employees, individual Home Care Providers, Virginia Home Care Authority, Established, Public Employee Relations Board Established, Exclusive Bargaining Representatives.

[03:03:24] The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill to pass and speak to that motion. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 378 is the bill that would establish collective bargaining for state and local government employees.

[03:03:41] The bill, first of all, I want to talk about what this bill is not. It is not an unfunded mandate. It does not mandate that people get raises or more benefits.

[03:03:56] What it does mandate is that if, if, if local government employees organize, if they choose to organize, then local governments and different parts of state agencies are required to have a conversation.

[03:04:18] That's it. They're required to have a conversation. about wages, benefits, quality of life, working conditions, etc. If they can't agree, parties go to mediation.

[03:04:33] If they still can't agree, they can go to arbitration. However, any arbitrator agreement is subject to the approval of the funding entity. In the case of the state, that would be us. In the case of local government, that would be either the Board of Supervisors, the City Council, or the Town Council.

[03:04:55] So the arbitrated agreement is subject to the approval of the body that provides the money. They don't got the money, there is no agreement. That's what the bill does. Now, I can get a lot more into the details if you want to talk about bargaining units and the 18 different potential bargaining units of the state and how bargaining units are formed at the local level.

[03:05:18] I can get into all that if you like. But that's basically what the bill does. I think it's important to note for the record what the Senate Finance Committee did. The biggest thing, two biggest things the Senate Finance Committee did to the bill was, number one, it basically took home health care workers, Medicaid-funded home health care workers, out of the bill.

[03:05:39] The bill is drafted, created an authority for home health care workers so that the home health care workers would be, Medicaid-funded home health care workers, would become employees of this authority and thus employees of the state. The Finance Committee was concerned about the fiscal impacts associated with that, So they eliminated that from the bill and mandated a study to look at that.

[03:06:03] That's the first big thing that was done. The second thing is Senate Finance Committee also said you cannot collectively bargain about health care benefits. The reason for that is that the state's health care plan applies to over 700,000 people. And trying to individually negotiate that between 400 local government units and the 18 different bargaining units of the state would create a sort of chaotic health care plan.

[03:06:30] so that is excluded and by the way the bill had previously excluded retirement benefits because retirement benefits are determined by us by statute so that was already out of the bill other people have said to me by the way won't employees be able to strike to force people to agree the answer that is no because the bill banned strikes still specifically prohibits strikes so the the leverage that that employees could exert is mainly that of public relations um you know telling local governments or the state that we really should fund these things that they've

[03:07:06] negotiated. The Senate Finance Committee also delayed the effective date to 2028. The Department of Labor and Industry says that it will take that long at least in order to write the regulations necessary to implement this. It also asked the new Public Employee Relations Board to conduct a study as to whether or not having 18 different bargaining units within the Commonwealth is really the correct number or the correct organization whether it be ought to be more or less um and uh they moved the transition date i guess to 2028 as well not only delayed effective date but the

[03:07:44] transition date so that's basically what the bill did i'll just say madam president that um what this bill will do is it will give 700 000 people who work for the government the right to collectively bargain whether it's for local government or state government that's 17 of the workers of this state right now only about 80 85 000 employees have the benefit of collective bargaining basically folks who live in arlington alexandria fairfax prince william and loudon counties i don't believe any of the states have adopted the opt-in collective bargaining we authorized back in 2021 um but

[03:08:22] madam president i believe that whether you have the opportunity to collectively bargain should not be a function of your zip code if you live in this state and your government employee you You either ought to have it or you shouldn't, and this makes sure everybody has that right. If they're able to convince their colleagues in their similar jobs that they ought to have a union, which they have to do first.

[03:08:43] Madam President, that's what the bill does. I hope we can pass it. The Senator from Rockingham. Madam President, I rise to speak to the bill. Senator has the floor. Madam President, members of the Senate, I was born at night, but it wasn't last night.

[03:09:06] I listened to my friend, the senator from Eastern Fairfax, say that this bill has no cost. And he said that a lot. And I think there are people around Virginia, some people, who've heard it, who actually

believe it.

[03:09:23] But I would point out that a couple of minutes ago we had a bill that was pulled because of the fiscal impact. Apparently, our Department of Planning and Budget doesn't believe it because they've assigned a $53 to $55 million fiscal impact to this bill.

[03:09:44] Apparently, local governments across Virginia don't believe it either because the local governments who have reported their belief as to the fiscal impact, many have not even reported but those who have reported have reported that this may cost local governments meaning local taxpayers across the commonwealth of virginia 400 million dollars

[03:10:15] 400 million dollars i hear that if we don't have the money we don't have to do it well the way it's going to work out in reality is if we don't have the money we're going to raise taxes so we can do it this is going to be a budget buster and you know I find it interesting when we are about to bust the budget it seems like we never want to do it during our current election cycle you know we're passing the bill now but we're passing

[03:10:48] the buck the bill for the bill until July 1 of 2028 after the November 2027 elections you know we owe it to the people of Virginia to be transparent to be honest about the cost and the expense of this thing this is going to raise real estate taxes all over the Commonwealth of Virginia it's going to raise income tax for people in Virginia we're gonna find I bet you we find creative ways to raise taxes left and right to be able to pay for this it's going to cut raise the cost of higher education for families across the

[03:11:26] Commonwealth of Virginia this is most assuredly not part of any affordability effort it may be part of the unaffordability effort for a number of state and local employees but people who are working hard to support their families who are not government employees across the Commonwealth of Virginia are going to be stuck with the bill for this and by the time it's 2028 after the elections when this bill comes due on people of the Commonwealth of Virginia you know it's gonna be too late to do anything I hope that we will give

[03:12:04] the people of the Commonwealth of Virginia a break give them a tax break if you want to wait until 2028 to start this let's start it over in the General Assembly session in January of 2028 we can get ready for it but we owe it to the people of Virginia to do it during the biennium that we're in not to pass the buck not to try and pull wool over their eyes and i hope that we will say no to this and help the

[03:12:38] people of commonwealth of virginia find true affordability the chair recognizes the senator from franklin county thank you madam president speaking against the bill the senator has the floor hey madam president i'm reminded of course earlier in this discussion today when we're talking about something else and of course we're talking about washington dc and the president and all that stuff that if you guys are against defunding the police then you should vote for this bill but somehow this is the only way we're going to fund our police our firefighters our state police our local uh our local officials our local government workers which is nonsense madam

[03:13:17] president i rise in opposition to senate bill 378 and i want to begin with something that i think every member of this chamber can actually agree on we're going to start today agreeing on something that the men and women who serve the public in the commonwealth our teachers firefighters sheriffs deputy social workers deserve to be treated fairly with dignity and with respect and we come in here every year

and we try to find the money so that they can be paid what they're worth sometimes we fall short there's always an argument that it's never enough but we treat all of our public

[03:13:52] employees with fairness and respect i've carried bill after bill in this body to increase deputy sheriff compensation protect volunteer first responders our firefighters and to support the very people that this bill claims that it is helping the madam president good intentions do not make good law and this bill Senate bill 378 is not a bill about respecting workers it's a bill about transferring power away from locally elected officials away from taxpayers away from the communities these workers serve and handing it to a state created bureaucracy and the national labor organizations that want this legislation so very badly and when

[03:14:32] you understand what this bill actually does not what it promises or not the hyperbole we hear on the floor, but what it actually does, then I believe every member of this chamber should actually vote no. Let me be precise about Senate Bill 378, Mountain President, about what it does, because the rhetoric around this bill has been carefully designed to obscure the actual substance of it. This bill repeals Virginia's long-standing prohibitions on collective bargaining by public employees. It creates new state agencies, the Public Employee Relations Board, with power to determine bargaining units, overseas certifications of

[03:15:07] elections that impose binding arbitration on local governments that fail to reach agreements at the negotiating table. Let me say that again. Binding arbitration. That means if a locality and a union cannot agree on a contract, an elected arbiter appointed by the state board with no specific government representation can dictate then those terms. And guess what? Madam President, the locality has to comply. The taxpayers have to pay. And the elected officials who are sent to office to manage those budgets, they're put on the sidelines. In 2020, we took a measured step. It allowed localities to opt in to collective bargaining. It

[03:15:47] respected the diversity of the of the regions, the various regions of this Commonwealth. It let local leaders decide what worked for their communities. And as of this date, 17 localities have since adopted bargaining ordinances. The system for them, what's right for them works. But a one-size-fits-all position is not the right position for this Senate to take. But why it's working right now with the opt-in is because it still preserves local choice and local control. But Senate Bill 378 throws that all away. It replaces a system built on choice with

[03:16:23] now one built on compulsion. The fiscal catastrophe that is going to fall, our various communities cannot be overstated. We don't have to guess. We have a case study and it is the wealthiest county in the commonwealth of which we can draw our knowledge in which to vote or not vote for this fairfax county adopted collective bargaining the fairfax education unions negotiated a contract that included a seven percent across the board pay raise and within months fairfax county was staring at nearly a 300 million dollar budget shortfall

[03:17:02] the board of supervisors could not fund the contract the union blamed the supervisor the supervisors blamed the school board the school board blamed richmond and the taxpayers well they they got a real estate tax increase and watch the promises made at the bargaining table dissolve before the ink was even dry on the agreement. That's just Fairfax County and that's a jurisdiction with a five and a half billion dollar annual budget. A jurisdiction with one of the highest as we've said many times highest

median household incomes in the nation and mandatory collective bargaining nearly broken. Now I want every member of this chamber to think about what that means for

[03:17:38] the rest of us us that represent not Rova but Rova the rest of Virginia in the 7th district I represent a very rural area in every one of my counties where there be Henry County Patrick County Floyd County Franklin County Pennsylvania County Bedford County Danville wherever it is these communities where local governments operate operate on razor-thin margins because why because our tax base is different the amount of income that the state governments derive from sales tax, from real property tax, from car tax, is not the same as Northern Virginia.

[03:18:17] There is a difference. Where county administrators in my area are already making impossible choices between road maintenance, school funding, law enforcement, social services, we don't have the luxury of the ability to raise taxes on our people because they've got the money. But if Fairfax County, with its billions in revenue, could not absorb the fiscal shock of mandatory collective bargaining. What happens to my people in Patrick County? How many millions of dollars must then be raised in order to overcome the deficit created by collective bargaining? Millions. My people don't

[03:18:57] have it. Property tax will go up. Services will have to get cut. And the very workers this bill is supposed to help will watch their communities be hollowed out because local government cannot afford to function. The Virginia Associations of Counties has formally opposed this bill. They called the estimated total fiscal impact i'm quoting one word massive they testified in committee that mandating uniform bargaining frameworks ignore the enormous differences in population resources and administrative capacity across our localities and guess what ladies and

[03:19:32] gentlemen they're exactly right a bipartisan coalition of mayors from hampton roads bipartisan madam president wrote this body asking us that the local bargaining authority remain in the hands of the localities there were democrats and republicans standing together saying don't do this don't impose this on us please but this bill goes ahead and does it anyway throws away their opinions throws away their requests throws away their ability to know what's right for the localities when we sit up here in richmond and make judgment calls calling balls and strikes for

[03:20:08] them regardless of what their desires are so let me put this man president in concrete terms if i I might. The city of Roanoke estimated collective bargaining would add nearly $30 million in additional salary costs alone. That doesn't include the cost of hiring legal teams with bargaining expertise, the office space for union officials, a new bureaucratic infrastructure required to administer those contracts, or even the long-term pension impacts. Where does a rural county like the ones I represent find budget amounts of $40 million? Where do they find that

[03:20:43] kind of money? Madam President, they don't. There's just nowhere where we can find it. Madam President, I want to close by saying this. I share a perspective that I think may surprise some members of this body. I went back and looked in history and found where President Franklin Delano Roosevelt, the architect of the New Deal, the president who signed the Neighbor Relations Act, the man who did more to advance organized labor in the private sector than any other president in American history, deliberately excluded government employees from that act. And in a simple quote, he explained why. Roosevelt Scott wrote that the process of collective bargaining, as usually is understood, cannot

[03:21:22] be transplanted into the public service because he said it has a distinct and insurmountable limitation when applied to government workers.

[03:21:37] Ladies and gentlemen, I will make a simple observation. This bill takes power from local communities and gives it to a state board. It takes budget authority from the elected officials and gives it to unelected arbitrators. It takes a system that is already working and replaces it with a mandate that will cost millions and millions of dollars all across the Commonwealth.

[03:21:59] These are dollars the localities cannot afford. It will hit rural Virginia the hardest because rural Virginia has the fewest resources to absorb the blow. Ladies and gentlemen, I have a great respect for the public servants of this Commonwealth.

[03:22:16] I have fought for them in this chamber. We all have fought for them in this chamber, one time or another. But I will not vote to impose an unfunded mandate on every locality in the Commonwealth of Virginia. not vote to strip local governments of their authority to manage their own budgets.

[03:22:32] And I will not vote to create a system that benefits national labor organizations at the expense of working families in the Commonwealth of Virginia. So therefore, I urge my colleagues, please vote no on Senate Bill 378. Thank you, Madam President. The chair recognizes the Senator from Roanoke.

[03:22:53] Thank you, Madam President. I rise to speak much briefer to the bill. The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 378, if enacted, is going to substantially raise property taxes across the Commonwealth.

[03:23:08] In my annual pre-session meetings with my local elected officials back home, it wasn't the Republicans that spoke up about this. It was the Democratic elected officials that overwhelmingly said, "Please, do not force our jurisdiction into collective bargaining."

[03:23:26] They recognized what this was going to do. They recognized it was going to result in much higher taxes without any higher quality services to their constituents. Madam President, I think the only folks that are going to benefit from this, it's not going to be working families.

[03:23:42] Working families are going to get hit hard. The only folks that are going to benefit from it are going to be Republican candidates for boards of supervisors around the Commonwealth in a few years and listing agents once this is enacted. Thank you, Madam President.

[03:23:57] The chair recognizes the Senator from Hanover. Thank you, Madam President. president, would the senator from Eastern Fairfax yield for a question? Will the senator yield? The senator from the second wealthiest county in Virginia will yield for a question. The senator from Hanover has the floor. Madam President, ask the senator, can you tell me this implies to state employees, but does it comply to the employees of the legislative body of the General Assembly? Senator from

[03:24:33] Eastern Hedrico. Madam President I'll yield so the bill does not apply to lead slave branch or the judicial branch the reason for that is because there'll be a violation of separation of powers the Public Employee Review Board which arbitrate what deals with disputes over who ought to be the correct bargaining unit etc is a branch that's controlled by the as a body controlled by the executive branch and we cannot and should not give them authority to make decisions about employment decisions in our branch or the judicial branch and

[03:25:11] that's why it was structured that way. Madam President, would the senator yield for an additional question? Will the senator yield? I yield. Senator from Hanover. Madam President, I'd ask the senator, is there any additional provision that would set up a separate collective bargaining entity for

employees of the legislature? Senator from Fairfax. That's not in the bill but if you want to talk about it, I'm all ears.

[03:25:35] Madam President, would the Senator yield for an additional question? Will you yield, Senator? I'll yield. Senator from Hanover. Madam President, I'd ask the Senator, are there any provisions in the bill that would say dues collected from a state or local employee would be prohibited from being spent in political campaigns?

[03:26:00] Senator from Fairfax. I'd have to search the bill, but not to my recollection. Thank the senator. Madam President, speaking to the bill. The Senator has the floor. Madam President, you heard me harp a bunch of times about we should not be requiring others to do things we're not willing to do ourselves.

[03:26:22] There's a reason that we're not doing it. Madam President, this changes the direction that we have in Virginia. Right now, localities can make the choice to a collective bargain. Some have. The majority, the vast majority, have not.

[03:26:39] And Madam President, it is just not accurate to say that this is not going to cost a lot of money. It's going to cost a lot of money to localities, and it's going to cost a lot of money to Virginian taxpayers.

[03:26:56] To put that in a perspective, one jurisdiction close to Richmond estimated that it would cost them about $200 million a year. Based on their real estate tax, that would be over 25 cents a year additional to their real estate tax. Put that in a real perspective, an average $500,000 home, that's over $1,000 a year that they're going to be paying more in real estate tax. Madam President, this is going to

[03:27:31] cost Virginians more money. Madam President, if this is something that we think is so important that we're going to force localities to do it this is not a choice this is not an option that's the law today this is requiring that they go through the process and binding arbitration means this is the agreement you have to comply with the agreement it is the reason is binding is because that's you're forced to do it if you want mediation that means people come together talk about it see if they can come up with an agreement and

[03:28:10] But both sides can walk away. Binding arbitration does not let a side walk away. Somebody decides you're going to do this. Madam President, this is going to be expensive for Virginians. So no mistake, when this goes into effect in three years, when you see your car tax go up, you can look at this.

[03:28:34] When you see your real estate tax go up, you can look at this. And when you see your sales tax and income tax go up, you can look at this. You will know where it came from. Be warned. Thank you, Madam President.

[03:28:50] The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Nobody else desires to speak speaking of the bill? The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Let me clean up a few things here to make sure the record's really clear on what we're doing here.

[03:29:10] First of all, if anybody was concerned about dues being used for certain purposes, they're welcome to make an amendment to the bill. No amendment was made. I would submit that that was a strategic decision, number one. number one number two let's talk about this local fiscal impact or alleged local fiscal impact if you go look up the local fist i guess we've started doing these fiscal impact statements where we ask local governments to uh estimate the fiscal impact on things and we just let local

governments say whatever they feel like it and then we just put it in in writing as if it's actually true now if you want to go look at the fiscal impact for chesterfield county which i

[03:29:48] believe is the county the center was referring to on this on the fist you'll look it up on ls yourself chesterfield county claims this is going to cost them 197 million dollars in the first year and 200 million dollars or 200 some million dollars the second year what did they base that on well if you read their explanation they said according to the u.s bureau of labor statistics the median weekly earnings of union workers were 20 percent more than non-union workers so if we apply a 20 increase to full-time salaries we get this number that's where this number comes from that's that's the funny math chesterfield county threw into this conversation to try to put a poison pill in the

[03:30:28] debate. Now, if Chesterfield County wants to give a 20% raise, that's up to them. If they want to do an agreement to do that, that's their decision. I would submit I don't think they're going to do that. Now, in terms of the two-year delay, under Virginia's regulatory process, it takes two years to do regulations unless we override that by statute. It's going to take two years to set up the structures necessary to process 400 plus bargaining units being created around the Commonwealth if they're able to organize them and get them in place to where

[03:31:06] they're even able to have a conversation. It takes time to put all that together and I would submit that I don't even think that anyone's capable of organizing that many bargaining units that quickly and I suspect that many localities the employees are not going to choose to want to be represented by a union. So again this whole thing only starts if the employees choose to let a union represent them. Let's talk about binding. I would direct the body to look at

[03:31:40] section 40.157.17 of this bill. And on line 637 and 638 of the bill, it says that after the matter is submitted to arbitration, it says, I'm going to read it word for word, if the governing body rejects the submission of the public employer, either party may reopen negotiations. It says the governing body shall approve or reject their submission as a whole, and if they reject the

[03:32:18] submission, either party may reopen negotiations. That's not binding. That's a choice. If the governing body doesn't have the money, then they don't agree to what came out of the arbitration. That's almost what happened in Fairfax, which, by the way, is the second wealthiest county in the state. Loudoun County, by the way, is the wealthiest. And I would note that in Fairfax, what happened is, yes, there were contracts that were negotiated and the budget went south.

[03:32:54] it didn't go south because of planned raises it went south because the real estate market cratered it went south because post-pandemic office building prices have gone down by about 70 percent in Fairfax County it is his fault it is his fault he transferred lots of competent contractors out of northern Virginia and and his agencies are transferring out of state but I would submit that the value there's buildings in Fairfax County they're now selling for 30 percent of

[03:33:30] their tax assessed value. And Fairfax County for years has overdeveloped commercial, underdeveloped residential to attract more jobs than houses because it benefits their revenue. It doesn't cost them as much on the expenditure side. And now those chickens are coming home to roost.

[03:33:48] But Fairfax didn't have the money. So you know what? They didn't fund the contract. And now they're back to the drawing board to renegotiate. So Madam President, that's what happened in Fairfax and it's not the contracts that caused the deficit. 24 states in America have collective bargaining at the

government level. Virginia will make us, will make it the 25th state in the country. And I would note that the states with collective bargaining rights, they have higher employee retention rates, they have better working conditions, they have higher levels of economic

[03:34:25] growth, lower levels of economic inequality. And I want to remind everybody that our public sector workers are those who are on the front lines working to protect us every day. We have natural disasters or, God forbid, another pandemic. This bill will give our public workers the ability to have a voice that they don't have right now in their working conditions and their pay and benefits. It's supported, by the way, by 68% of the public, according to a CNU poll that came out recently. We need to pass this bill.

[03:34:52] The question is, shall Senate Bill 378 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[03:35:11] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, noes 18. Ayes 22, noes 18. Senate Bill 378 passes. Madam Chair, Madam President.

[03:35:32] For what purpose does a senator from Chesapeake rise? Haven't been on the prevailing side by which we passed this last bill, and Senate Bill 378 has to be reconsidered. The question is, shall the vote by which Senate Bill 378 passed be reconsidered?

[03:36:00] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[03:36:19] Ayes 40, no, zero. Ayes 40, no, zero. The motion is agreed to. The question is? Madam President. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. I move the bill to pass, and having previously explained the bill, I would hope we would pass the bill again.

[03:36:40] The chair requests that the senators speak for another 15 minutes about the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 378 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[03:36:57] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19.

[03:37:15] Senate Bill 378 passes. Senate Bill 386, a bill relating to distribution of sewage sludge PFA's substances testing requirements, civil penalty.

[03:37:37] The senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President. And I would move the bill pass in speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, members, this is the bill dealing with PFAS in biosolids that are being applied to land in Virginia and used as fertilizer.

[03:37:58] The bill that you have that came out of Senate Finance Committee is not going to be the bill that it is. We have been working on this ever since the first day of session. And as of this morning, a compromise was negotiated that I understand the sewer treatment folks support, the localities support, and the Farm Bureau supports.

[03:38:21] And I just got that final word from Farm Bureau. And we've worked really hard to find a place where we could get a ramp down of how much of this PFAS and biosolids would be applied over a reasonable period of time so the sewer treatment plants could be able to do that but likewise protect human health if you don't know pfos it causes cancer birth defects a number of things it's what they call the forever chemicals

[03:38:54] chemicals and they're just not breaking down in our ecosystem so i'll answer any questions i'm happy to but the last report i got was that the compromise is good everybody's in favor with it and if this passes the senate we'll drop that substitute on it and the house is going to do the same thing and we won't have talk about this anymore so i hope everybody votes for it the senior senator from fairfax thank you madam president i want to thank the senator from king george uh for his efforts here uh this was a very very concerning bill we wanted to make sure that

[03:39:32] we did not end up with a standard we could not meet and uh uh we have pulled a number of people together with the administration and all the folks that the senator from King George mentioned and I spoke earlier to some of my colleagues about supporting this bill and I can say we can support it even more at this point in time because all of the issues have been resolved we have peace in the valley we'll fix this in uh in in in committee and again thanks uh thank you senator

[03:40:02] from King George. The question is, shall Senate Bill 386 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 27, noes 13. Ayes 27, noes 13. Senate Bill 386 passes. Senate Bill 391, a bill relating to commission on

[03:40:41] the Virginia alcohol safety action program. The senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President. Move the bill pass in speaking to it. The senator has the floor. Madam President, this was a bill that came out of the VASAP commission. It was unanimous to sort of restructure the existing governance, put it in a coherent place in the code of Virginia, and ultimately it required the localities to participate in the program. We actually, when

[03:41:14] And when some of the localities became upset with that, we stepped back on that, and it requires a work group now for them to work with us to figure out how to make the program successful. Because under Virginia law, you're convicted of a DUI. You cannot drive unless you participate in BASAP.

[03:41:31] And some of the localities' programs were failing, which obviously injures people in not being able to get a license unless the office in Richmond takes it up. So we have another compromise here, bill here, that the locality's supported and everybody's supported, and hopefully we can pass this.

[03:41:51] The question is, shall Senate Bill 391 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[03:42:10] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. Senate Bill 391 passes.

[03:42:28] Senate Bill 408. A bill relating to solicitations or contributions, enforcement, private right of action. The Senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President. Move the bill pass and speaking to it.

[03:42:44] Senator has the floor. Madam President, members, very simply, this bill creates a cause of action if you give money to a charitable institution they do not use that money for the purpose that they promised you they were going to use it for you can give it to them openly with no strings attached but there are a number of charities out there and we had this situation in my district where a particular charity was asking for money for a specific purpose over a period of time that purpose ceased and they sought to liquidate

[03:43:23] and use the money for other purposes up to this point in time only the attorney general the county attorney could file suit but this would allow an individual to sue recover their actual damages or five hundred dollars whichever is greater and they can get attorney's fees if they're successful and there's a willful refusal to return your money senator from chesapeake the question is madam

[03:44:01] President. Senator from Northern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Question for speaking to this bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. My understanding with if we are to pass this bill, this would not only apply to the ongoing case that Senator from King George is referring to, but it would also potentially have consequences for our private

[03:44:31] colleges, for other nonprofits. This really has wide-ranging potential effects, and I would encourage the body to vote against the bill very gently. I understand he intends to do good with this, but I think this sets us up for a real challenge for our private colleges and universities as well as our non-profits the senator from western fairfax thank you madam president i rise for

[03:45:04] a question question to the patron yes senator from king george will you yield i yield senator from fairfax um uh my question madam president is i am worried about the comments that my um colleague here just made and considering non-profits and um you know when i think of nonprofits I also think of school PTAs and wonder if this bill would include them senator from King George madam president answer the senator this would

[03:45:42] include any charitable entity that takes your money and says they're going to do one thing with it we're gonna build a bus stop we're gonna do and whatever it is and then they take that money and divert it to another use which is what they what not what they promised you they would do is that answer senator thank you madam president speaking to the bill senator has the floor thank you madam president so I believe that basically that answer is yes and and

[03:46:19] this has such far-reaching consequences I mean when you're talking and you know I'm just gonna go down to the level of volunteers in a school PTA who are out there hustling trying to raise funds for kids and they say you know we need funds for books and for a field trip and then for whatever reason that doesn't come to fruition and they divert the funds to another you know worthwhile endeavor that still benefits kids and now we're gonna open them up to being

[03:46:59] sued for not placing every dollar exactly where they had potentially said it may go I just I just think this will raise havoc for our nonprofits in particular so I urge my colleagues to vote no senator from King George thank Thank you, Madam President.

[03:47:26] If no one else wishes to speak... Senator has the floor. Madam President, this is only for situations where they refuse to give the money back. And so, or they don't have the authority to do it. It's only for willful refusal, and at the end of the day, we give a lot of money to a lot of charitable causes.

[03:47:49] And if they tell us they're going to do something with it, they should do that with it. And if they don't, if an individual asks for the money back, they should get their money back. I will tell you in any other sense, that's a criminal offense in Virginia called obtaining money by false pretenses.

[03:48:08] So I don't think we should allow people to do that under the civil law just because it's a charitable entity. Does the senator from Northern Fairfax wish to speak again? President, just a question for the patron.

[03:48:27] Will the senator yield? I'll yield. Senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I'm wondering if he might be able to tell me if currently the Attorney General would have the responsibility to go after individuals who are in this situation.

[03:48:43] Senator from King George. Madam President, currently I think I said it was the Attorney General or the County Attorney in a particular area where the offense occurred. Thank you, Madam President. That's all I have. I would encourage people to vote against this bill.

[03:49:01] The question is, shall Senate Bill 408 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[03:49:24] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 17, noes 21, rule 36-2. Ayes 17, noes 21, rule 36-2.

[03:49:40] The bill does not pass. Senate bill 494 a bill relating to public institutions of higher education governing boards membership appointment terms and composition duties relating to shared governance requirements work group the senator from charlottesville madame president move the bill pass this bill can is a feels with restructuring i'm sorry i move the bill pass i'd like to speak to the bill senator has the floor um this bill deals with restructuring of higher education governing structures. It contains elements of the bill that the majority leader introduced and I just want to go over a few of the things that

[03:50:19] it does. It extends the terms of the members of boards of visitors to six years and limits them to one term. It says that those terms don't become effective until their appointments are approved by the both House and Senate privileges and elections committees. It ensures that students, staff, and faculty members have faculty members are on each board of visitors they aren't voting members but they are selected by their own peer groups the student member is selected from a group of people appointed but are nominated by the Student Government Association there are a lot of other changes but those are the

[03:50:56] most significant ones again I would ask that a pass the senator from Roanoke thank you madam president will the senator from Bath yield for a question possibly two. I will. Will the senator from Charlottesville yield? I will, yes ma'am. Senator from Roanoke. Thank you, Madam President. Apologies to the senator from Charlottesville. I have fond memories of the time he represented Bath. My question to him is with the change in the cycle

[03:51:34] of appointments, what would this create the situation for the next executive with their ability to appoint senator from Charlottesville eventually that madam chair madam president I would say to the gentleman that eventually the idea is you've got a wall between part of the partisan world and boards of visitors eventually you'll have half of a board of visitor board of visitors appointed by one governor the other half appointed by the next governor so there's some separation between politics and the board of visitors current members will serve out their term but the next from here on out there will be six-year terms

[03:52:13] from the effective date of this legislation July 1. Madam President, will he yield for one more question? Will the senator from Charlottesville yield? Yes ma'am. Senator from Roanoke. Thank you madam president. I asked the senator from Charlottesville so will the practical effect of that be that the next executive will not be able to appoint members to these boards? Senator from Charlottesville. Madam chair I will say no that's that will not be the practical effect. The The practical effect will be that the next

executive and every executive after that will have the opportunity to appoint half of the membership of a Board of Visitors.

[03:52:51] So that ultimately you will have half appointed by one executive and half appointed by the next executive. If they are approved, that's exactly, if they are approved. And this bill does not address the law of misfeasance, malfeasance or nonfeasance, and Theoretically, a governor could find or ask members to resign, but the way this is set up, half the members are to be appointed by one executive, the other half by the next executive.

[03:53:26] Thank you, Madam President. Thank the Senate for Charlottesville. The question is, shall Senate Bill 494 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[03:53:42] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, noes 18. Ayes 22, noes 18. Senate bill 494 passes. Senate bill 541, a bill relating to time zone permanent eastern standard time in the commonwealth. The senator from King George. Thank you madam president. Move the bill pass and speaking to it. The senator has the floor. So madam president, every year, twice a year, we either turn the clocks forward or we

[03:54:18] turn the clocks back and this is a bill to stop the madness it's it's interesting in committee we had a doctor from northern virginia never met him before in my life he found out about the bill and he actually testified about all of the health impacts mentally physically emotionally all of the above and how detrimental it is for us to turn the clocks forward and back every year and you all know every spring we lose a lot of old folks it's just a fact of life every spring because they

[03:54:56] can't adjust to that time change and and i'll be honest with you i don't know why we torture ourselves twice a year but we do we go through it it's hard on school children it's hard on us it's just silly so i have brought a bill to fix that um to stop the madness thank you and the committee in its wisdom and i thought it was a very good move put in the bill that we'd also have to get dc and maryland to go along with us and i think they will because virginia's always

[03:55:33] been a leader and virginia is once again leading to stop this nonsense and and if we can get this thing through you have my commitment that i will go to dc and i will go to maryland both and talk them into this so please vote for this bill to stop the madness the chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William with the gentleman rise for question will the senator from King George yield will the senator from King George yield yes I yield senator from Prince William thank you thank you with the gentleman tell me is the he stated that the amendment from the committee

[03:56:13] was a good idea but is it not pending a future action in the future of something other action depending on this becoming in effect. Senator from King George. Madam President as I read the bill if it passes the this body the other body and the governor signs it as I said we've got to talk Maryland and DC into this as well and I'm committed to doing that. Senator from Prince William. I didn't say that. I did not say it was a trigger bill Madam President. I said I said I am

[03:56:50] We're committed to working with Maryland and DC to see that all of us stop the madness. Senator from Prince William. I thank the gentleman, the time's a-wasting and he's seated our sovereignty in Maryland.

[03:57:08] Does the senator from, junior senator from Loudoun wish to speak? Yes. Will the senator from King George yield for a question? Quick question. Will the senator yield? I'd be happy to yield. Senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. I would ask the senator from King George if he would not give a lawyerly answer and just say yes or no.

[03:57:29] Senator from King George. I apologize to the senator, Madam President, I didn't understand the question.

[03:57:52] Does the senator from Western Prince William wish to speak? Thank you. Madam President, will the senator yield for a question? Will the senator from King George yield? Happily yield, Madam President. Thank you, Madam President. Senator has the floor. Madam President, noting proper procedure, I would say I would ask the senator, which seems to be lost in this body, I would ask the senator if he could remind the body, which member in committee made the amendments for both DC and Maryland?

[03:58:18] Senator from King George. It may have been the senator from Prince William, I can't remember exactly. Follow-up question, Madam President. Senator. Will the senator yield for a follow-up question? I yield. Will the senator yield? I yield. Madam President. Senator has the floor.

[03:58:33] I would ask the senator, there are three members of the Prince William delegation. Which one was it, by geography? Senator from King George. I can't remember. I'm sorry. Madam President, speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Madam President, it was the senator from Western Prince William who made that amendment.

[03:58:53] And I would implore the members of the other side of the aisle to please remember the geography of the members on this side, as we have been repeatedly referred to as the senator from Western Fairfax, no, senator from all over at this point, that said, the reason, Madam President, I made this amendment in the first place is because the very actual real national security issues that we have with this, DC and Maryland cannot be on a different time schedule than Virginia because you will absolutely have human error that contributes to major

[03:59:29] actual problems when we were dealing with our national security apparatus that is tied throughout the DMV region. And so while I'd like to have a lot of fun with this part, that's the very serious nature of this. You cannot get that part wrong. And it would be my preference that our absolutely dysfunctional, basically mostly useless Congress actually pass a bill for once to deal with this nationwide.

[03:59:52] But in lieu of that, because they can't legislate the way of a wet paper bag, we have to delete in Virginia. And the only way I want us to lead in Virginia is by making sure we do not screw up the national security apparatus that binds the DMV together. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, no one else wishes to speak. I forgot to mention this. I brought this bill a few years ago, and it was equally as much fun, but I will never forget the former senator from Mecklenburg, Senator Ruff, when he opined on this bill. And he supported it, by the way, But he said, the only thing my dog knows is when the sun comes up and the sun comes down.

[04:00:29] And I don't need to know any more about this than my dog. So please vote for this bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 541 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes.

[04:00:45] Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 24, noes 16.

[04:01:03] Ayes 24, noes 16. Senate Bill 541 passes. Senate Bill 542, a bill relating to cannabis control retail market penalties. The chair recognizes a senator from Eastern Henrico.

[04:01:22] Madam President, I move this bill pass and I would like to speak to that motion. The senator has the floor. Madam President, there are many in this chamber that has helped shape this legislation. The Senate will be in order. senator from eastern henrico will proceed thank you so much um madam president there are many in this chamber as we heard just as recent as yesterday that have helped shaped this legislation but it has changed and taken on many forms so i apologize in advance as i try to clear up the smoke around some of this spill in this current forum ahead of us and so um madam president

[04:02:01] madam president the substitute that we passed yesterday um it takes on a lot of what many members have seen previously but it also takes some new approaches so i first like to start with the governance um this new legislation this legislation now takes on the approach where the cannabis control authority will manage the license and regulatory portions while the marketplace is immediately being stood up but it does state the intent of the general assembly to transition to the cannabis control alcoholic beverage and cannabis control authority as of January 1,

[04:02:35] 2028. Madam President, it also establishes a tax rate of 12.875% with an additional 3% local tax. One of the main differences that many members may notice is that in past versions there was a referendum included and the version before this body there is not a referendum. The timeline for the market rollout is as follows the permit applications begin our date is jen july 1 2026 for the permit applications to begin the seed to sell tracking begins september 1 2026

[04:03:10] with a retail market to open on january 1 2027. madam president the transaction limit for retail purchases will remain at 2.5 ounces which has always been throughout this process and it does established several standards for the lottery process for impact licensees. Madam President, the cultivation licensing structure on canopy sides breaks it down into tiers with tiers one through five with five being the largest at 35,000 square feet. The retail license caps are adjusted to 350 retail stores statewide with an additional cap on cultivation facilities at 450 up until and

[04:03:49] through the 2028 period at home cultivation will continue to be permitted with up to four plants legally allowed to be grown at home as long as you have your name and id listed on the tag of each of those plants the thc limits for non-pharmaceutical purchases are at 10 milligrams per serving and 100 milligrams per package and there are a number of robust criminal provisions within the legislation to ensure that we're working to crack down on the illicit sale in

[04:04:22] the illicit marketplace. Madam President there are a lot of details in this legislation but the key components that I have listed I think grasp the majority of the changes. So again I'd ask that we move this forward. The question is shall Senate Bill 542 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 20 nose 19

[04:05:03] rule 36 1 eyes 20 nose 19 rule 36 1 because this legislation requires 21 votes the bill does not pass senate bill 543 a bill relating to marijuana and hemp products enforcement madam president i also move that this legislation move forward and i'd like to speak to that motion the senator has

[04:05:42] the floor thank you so much madam president this legislation is i would say a companion to the larger bill i just described but this is specifically focused on enforcement madam president in this

language we allow for the enforcement authority to be granted to the cannabis control authority with explicit law enforcement powers to include the authority for designated investigators to issue summons, obtain warrants, and enforce regulatory compliance. We also maintain the authority for state and local entities to take licensing action against businesses engaged in illegal cannabis sales, which this is so critical especially to many of the vape

[04:06:19] shops that we have been notified participating in illegal sales, Madam President. This also creates a state-issued retail licensed decal requirement to allow consumers and regulators to verify that when they go into a retail location they can feel confident and certain that this is a legal and authorized location for them to purchase from it also requires DCJS to develop standardized training for law enforcement related to cannabis and hemp enforcement and further it establishes a work group for cannabis enforcement to coordinate among the state regulatory, agriculture, public safety and legal

[04:06:57] resources, excuse me, agencies with a report due back to us on October 1st, 2026. Madam President, this legislation allows for us to have the enforcement arm that we need to again crack down on the illicit marketplace and I'd ask that we move this forward. The question is, shall Senate bill 543 pass. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the

[04:07:25] senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 26, noes 14. Ayes 26, noes 14. Senate bill 543 passes.

[04:07:51] Senate Bill 565, a bill relating to Virginia Contractor Transaction Recovery Fund, claim limits, licensure, threshold amounts. Senator from Colonial Heights. Madam President, I move that the bill pass. And speaking to the bill.

[04:08:07] Senator has the floor. Madam President, Senate Bill 565 deals with the Contractor Transaction Recovery Fund, which is a DPOR consumer protection fund that can reimburse eligible homeowners for losses caused by the improper or dishonest conduct of a licensed residential contractor.

[04:08:23] that fund is funded by contractor assessments not tax dollars this bill does not change the standards or the dollar amounts that we updated unanimously last year it simply clarifies that those 2025 updates apply to claims filed on or after June 6 2024 that are later approved by the board for contractors so that similarly situated claimants are not treated differently based solely on when their approval happens and that's the bill it asks that pass the question is shall Senate bill 565 pass all in favor of that motion will record

[04:09:01] their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero Senate bill 565 passes Senate bill 5 Senator from Chesapeake. Thank you. Having voted on the prevailing side by which we failed to pass, Senate Bill 542 asks that we be reconsidered. The

[04:09:35] question is, shall the vote by which Senate Bill 542 did not pass be reconsidered? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any Any Senators desire to change their vote?

[04:10:00] The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no 0. Ayes 40, no 0. The motion is agreed to. Senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Having previously explained the bill, I again move that we move this legislation forward.

[04:10:18] Senator from Alexandria. Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the bill briefly. Senator has the floor. I had to abstain on the previous vote out of abundance of caution because I didn't want to appear that I represent the governor yet on this position, on this bill, and I have no financial stake and it's under the rules of the Senate I will be voting on this vote.

[04:10:44] Thank you. The question is, shall Senate Bill 542 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[04:11:01] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate bill 542 passes. Senate bill 598, a bill relating to electric utilities, renewable energy portfolio standard, zero carbon electricity,

[04:11:33] zero emission credits, power purchase agreements. The Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, Can I move the bill pass? I'd like to speak to that, please. The Senator has the floor. Madam Chair, a number of years ago, we passed the Clean Economy Act, then set goals to reduce the amount of carbon that was a byproduct of our energy production, and set a deadline for 2050 for the elimination of carbon for energy production.

[04:12:01] At the time we passed the Clean Economy Act, we set up this accredited, accelerated renewable energy buyer program in order to incentivize the growth of renewable energy. This changes that to accelerated clean energy buyer program in order to incentivize the growth of non-carbon producing energy which might not be renewable, primarily nuclear.

[04:12:28] Again, I ask that you vote for the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 598 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted?

[04:12:45] Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. Senate Bill 598 passes. Senate Bill 600, a bill relating to non-judicial disciplinary proceedings in the Virginia National Guard.

[04:13:07] Senator from Orange. Thank you, Madam President, ask the bill to pass and speak into that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, members of the body, as it stands right now, the Virginia National Guard is unable to discipline some soldiers with the reduction of rank, if they are ranked E5 or higher, with 10 or more years of service, and that really binds the hands of the Guard.

[04:13:29] If they have to do anything, the only two choices they have is reduction in pay, or just separate them from the Guard. They'd like to be able to have this other disciplinary tool in their toolbox, so they don't have to just kick people out of the Guard.

[04:13:44] They spent too much money trying to get them trained to put in there. It would allow the Guard officers to have that tool. It would not create a new form of non-judicial proceedings for the Guard to undertake, but remove that restriction. It does not affect the appeal process for the Guard members that they have at their disposal if they believe there was a lack of evidence or abuse.

[04:14:04] I ask the bill to pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 600 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 40 no zero eyes 40 no zero senate bill 600 passes senate bill 621 a bill to direct certain electric utilities to petition petition the state

[04:14:42] corporation commission for approval of electric grid utilization metrics the junior senator from Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass. I'm speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 621 requires the development of a standardized, transparent grid utilization metrics so that the State Corporation Commission can better evaluate how Virginia's transmission and distribution system is being used.

[04:15:09] The bill directs utilities to calculate seasonal utilization data, data at the feeder and substation level, providing clearer information to guide infrastructure planning and support long-term affordability by maximizing existing assets before new expansion.

[04:15:27] The substitute reflects stakeholder consensus and allows this analysis to be incorporated into the IRP process at the SEC's discretion. I hope it's a will of the body to adopt this bill. Thank you, Madam President. The question is, shall Senate Bill 621 pass?

[04:15:46] in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 21 nose 19 eyes 21 nose 19 senate bill 621 passes senate bill 647 a bill relating to use of unnamed aircraft systems by law enforcement officers search warrant senator Senator from Washington.

[04:16:22] Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill to pass and speak of the bill. Senator has the floor. Senate Bill 647 directs at DCJS to develop and establish guidelines governing drone operations by law enforcement under extremely limited circumstances, and I hope it's will-abody bill passed.

[04:16:42] The question is, the question is, shall Senate Bill 647 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted.

[04:16:58] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. Senate Bill 647 passes. Senate Bill 650: A bill relating to public utilities, water and sewage companies discounted rates for low-income customers.

[04:17:18] Senior Senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill pass. And speaking to that... The Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. This bill allows but does not require a water or wastewater utility to seek SCC approval for rates and tariff provisions that would lower bills for low-income customers while recovering the cost with a de minimis charge applied to the broader customer base.

[04:17:41] Allowing for lower rates will enable more low-income Virginians to stay current on their water bills, avoiding the disruption, threats to health and safety, and further costs associated service interruption and disconnection and I reiterate this affordability bill motion to pass thank you the question is shall Senate bill 650 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to

[04:18:14] change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 23 no 17 ayes 23 no 17 Senate bill 650 passes Senate bill 689 a bill relating to oral threat to kill or to do bodily harm employees of local or State Department of Social Services penalty senator from Mecklenburg thank you madam president I move the passage of the bill and speaking to that the senator has the floor thank you madam

[04:18:50] president this bill was brought to me by the Department of Social Services this This bill would add a Department of Social Services worker to a list of people that are protected like teachers and

healthcare workers against oral threats.

[04:19:10] It would make this a class one misdemeanor. This bill would close the gap. It would add them to the list again and the DSS employees and local social services workers to the existing protected category.

[04:19:28] The same penalty will apply to the DSS employees as currently applies to teachers and healthcare workers when an oral threat is made when they're doing their job. We all know this is a sensitive, DSS goes out and does very sensitive work when they are having to possibly remove a child from a home or they get in the middle of, you know, custody-type situations or there's a child being abused or accused of being abused.

[04:20:06] And so a lot of times it's a very tense situation and their lives are threatened and this would just put them into a protected category. Thank you. And I move passage of the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 689 pass?

[04:20:24] all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 39 knows one eyes 39 knows one senate bill 689 passes senate bill 738 a bill relating to hospitals emergency department physicians the senator from isle of white thank you madam president i move that the bill passed and like to speak to the bill

[04:21:01] senator has the floor thank you madam president um senate bill 730 is a common sense update to legislation this body passed last year in support of psychiatric eds across the state in hampton roads we've seen great success with the first year of our local psychiatric ed with seeing over 6 000 patients in 2025 alone underscoring the need for continued mental health and behavioral health services across our commonwealth what this bill does is a narrow exception to make sure that as we progress forward in servicing all of those that need behavioral health services specifically in hampton roads region this will allow a narrow carve out to allow those facilities to not have a

[04:21:42] 24 7 emergency room physician on staff rather there are other providers in the facility to be able to accommodate the direct needs of those seeking behavioral health needs and i move that the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 738 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero

[04:22:20] senate bill 738 passes senate bill 796 a bill relating to artificial intelligence companion chat box and miners act established enforcement civil penalties individual action and there is a floor amendment senator from stafford thank you madam president uh recon i move to reconsider the vote by which the bill was ordered to be engrossed in advance with student reading the question is shall the vote by which senate bill 796 was ordered to be engrossed in advance

[04:22:57] to its third reading be reconsidered all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero the motion is agreed to senator from stafford thank you madame president i move to waive the reading of the floor amendment the question is shall the reading of the floor amendment be waived all in favor of that

[04:23:33] motion will say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the reading is waived senator from stafford uh thank you madame president i move to agree to the floor amendment and explain it senator

has the floor thank you madam president um this uh will on line 47 we are um after on or that we are striking glorifies or promotes and inserting a courage advocates for insights and the purpose of that is that working with um uh senator uh from oh we just got talked to western western prince

[04:24:09] william thank you i had it in my head and then i got nervous i was gonna get it wrong i appreciate just to make sure that we were really striking at the heart of the intent of this and not getting into any gray area with interest to take license so I move that we move the amendment. The Senator from Western Prince William. Thank you Madam President. Madam President speaking to the amendment. Senator has the floor.

[04:24:32] Thank you Madam President. Madam President first I'd like to thank the patron for having a long dialogue we've gone back and forth back and forth about this. The reason I brought this up is that both the patron and I we have a a common goal here, which is we do not want chatbots trying to encourage kids to kill themselves. This is a real thing. We saw there's an AP story you can read from 2024 about a teen who right before dying that way had a conversation with the chatbot, and it's so heartbreaking to

[04:25:06] read. And so we are on agreement with a significant portion here. The issue that came up was legally speaking, when you're dealing with some terms that can be considered vague or undefined, what then falls into that? And so, there is a significant difference, for example, for between a person using a chatbot and a chatbot responding with explicit instructions to that person to kill themselves, versus if you were to use that chatbot and you were to ask it a question about music that has depressing content

[04:25:41] or basically are song subjects that deal with suicide. And so one example that I would give on this, for example, if someone were to be using the chat bot and they were to type into it, what is the song "Fade to Black" by Metallica about? The answer to that is that it's about suicide.

[04:25:57] It's one of the most, it is on the one hand, it's a very dark song. It's also one of the most beautiful songs I've ever heard in my life. But 40 something years ago, During one of the PMRC congressional hearings, someone actually held up a vinyl of the "Ride to Lightning" album that that one's on and specifically tried calling out that song and for advocating suicide rate, which it does not do.

[04:26:21] But I learned a long time ago, I remember I was in Gainesville at a place called Classic Axe, and I was taking guitar lessons back then. And I talked to a guy who had been a backup guitarist for B.B. King. And one day, he's playing a show, and he sees some friends out in the crowd, he smiles at them, waves, whatever.

[04:26:42] And then Bebe talks to him afterward, and he says, you don't smile when you're playing the blues. For a lot of people, when you are in a dark place, when you're in a bad, tough place, sometimes listening to songs that reflect to where you are in that moment is really therapeutic and very healing.

[04:27:00] And Metallica's front man has even talked about the hundreds and hundreds of letters that he's received about how Fade to Black actually really helped a lot of people and it's really powerful when you see it live. And so my goal here in talking back and forth with the Senator was making sure we weren't opening a jar for music censorship and that we were really trying to get at is what is causing and driving someone to basically take their life because the chatbot directly encouraged it.

[04:27:29] I recognize this is still a living document, I recognize it's still going to go to the house the most we can do to tighten that up the better and in the meantime i'll still vote to advance the bill so make sure

that you know we still have a vehicle so thank you madam president the question is shall the amendment be agreed to all in favor of that motion we'll say aye aye those opposed no the ayes have it the amendment is agreed to senator from stafford thank you Thank you, Madam President. I move to engrossed and advanced to the third reading.

[04:28:03] The question is, shall Senate Bill 796 now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senator from Stafford.

[04:28:19] Thank you, Madam President. I move to suspend the rules and dispense with the third constitutional reading. The question is, shall the rules now be suspended and the third reading of Senate Bill 796 be dispensed with? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[04:28:35] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0.

[04:28:53] Ayes 40, noes 0. The reading of the title is dispensed with. Senator from Stafford. Thank you, Madam President. I move to pass the bill and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you. First, I just want to extend my real sincere gratitude to working with my colleagues from Western Enrico and also from Eastern Fairfax.

[04:29:16] I hope I passed that test on our location. I'm very grateful for it. This, as my colleague had alluded to about chatbots, this is a very, very dangerous and scary time for our children that are seeking to engage in relationships with companion chatbots.

[04:29:35] And that's the purpose of what this bill is doing. There has been some absolutely heartbreaking stories that we spoke about in committee about where there's been some ideation belief that they are not in fact chatting with an AI chatbot.

[04:29:51] And so that's exactly what this bill seeks to do is put some real strong parameters around that. there is a 24-hour emergency intervention for those that may be getting into a forming actual knowledge that the minor is at imminent risk there is a requirement for operators that when the minor is developing an unhealthy emotional dependence that it takes reasonable steps with the pop-up notification that you are in fact speaking with the chat bot this is not a real person and there's

[04:30:26] that ideation that that we've seen with some of these um interactions um there is so they cannot materially represent themselves as a human being and the child can never be manipulated in that respect and there is the limited access mode so there is um with parental um guard rails um it doesn't prohibit them from using it but there are some important verifications and parental consent that has to be obtained so i hope it is the will of the body that we we pass this bill thank you very much madam president the question is shall senate bill 796 pass all in favor of that motion

[04:31:06] will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 39 knows one ayes 39 nose 1 senate bill 796 passes senate bill 819 a bill relating to virginia lottery powers of the virginia lottery board advertising restrictions age verification senator from roanoke

[04:31:44] thank you madam president i move that senate bill 819 pass speaking of that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president uh the title for the bill is a little misleading now in that the The

bill does three things. The primary thing the bill does coming out of committee is provide for age verification at the terminals.

[04:32:07] That's what is required to go forward with it. Two, is also required that the troubled gambling number be included in these materials like it is for other parts of gaming in the Commonwealth. And then three, which is what the title was referring to, It directs the lottery to look at the advertising regulations.

[04:32:29] And with that, I hope the Senate will adopt the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 819 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted?

[04:32:45] Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no zero. Ayes 40, no zero. Senate Bill 819 passes. Returning to page 13, Senate Bill 673.

[04:33:07] The Senator from Mecklenburg. Thank you, Madam President. Having previously explained the bill, I move that it pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 673 pass?

[04:33:23] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no 0.

[04:33:40] Ayes 40, no 0. Senate Bill 673 passes. Uncontested calendar, Senate bills on second reading. The senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, move all the Senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 33 through 34, Senate bills 528 through 804.

[04:34:02] Be advanced to their engrossment. And third reading in the block, I have the adoption of any amendments there to any senator desiring a move bill from the block. We'll do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, shall all the Senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 33 through 34, Senate Bill 528 through Senate Bill 804, be engrossed in advance to their third reading in the block after the adoption of the amendments thereto, that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill.

[04:34:36] all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the motion is agreed to the clerk will read the number of the bills Senate bill 528 reported from the committee for courts of justice with the substitute senator from Franklin County thank you madam president I now move that the substitute be agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the substitute is agreed to Senate bill 753 reported from the committee for courts of justice Senate bill 804 reported from the

[04:35:15] committee for courts of justice the question is shall the Senate bills now be engrossed in advance to their third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the bills are engrossed and advanced to their third reading senator from Eastern Fairfax Madam President, I move that all the Senate bill is now on third reading on the uncontested calendar, pages 33 through 34 to Senate Bill 528 through 804, that the rules be suspended and the third reading of the titles be dispensed with.

[04:35:45] The question is, shall the rules be suspended and the third reading of the titles of the bills be dispensed with? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[04:36:02] The clerk will close. the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. The bills are now before the Senate on final passage. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, move all the Senate bills now on third reading uncontested calendar on pages 33 through 34 to Senate Bill 528 through Senate Bill 804 be placed on their final passage in the block. Any Senator desiring move bill from the block, please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill.

[04:36:31] The question is, shall the Senate bills on the uncontested calendar now on their third reading pages 33 through 34, Senate Bill 528 through Senate Bill 804, be placed upon their final passage in the block with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill.

[04:36:52] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bills are before us in the block. The clerk will read the number of the bills. bill 528 senate bill 753 senate bill 804 the question is shall the bills in the block pass all in favor of the passage of the bills will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote

[04:37:26] the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero the bills in the block pass regular calendar senate bills on second reading senate bill 15 relating to driver improvement clinics motorcycle driver improvement clinics motorcycle driver improvement clinic fund created

[04:38:04] the senate will be in order reported from the committee on finance and appropriations with a substitute senator from roanoke thank you madam president i have a motion uh mad president under

[04:38:20] Under Rule 20G, I ask that Senate Bill 15 be recommitted to the Committee on Senate Transportation.

[04:38:55] The question is, shall Senate Bill 15 be recommitted and carried over to the 2027 session? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[04:39:11] Those opposed, no. No. The no's have it. The bill is not recommitted.

[04:39:26] Senator from Roanoke. Madam President. from Roanoke. Would the recommendation that it be rejected, I move that the Senate adopt the committee substitute. With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Finance and Appropriations be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. No. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to.

[04:40:04] Senator from Roanoke. Madam President, I ask that the bill go by temporarily. Without objection, Senate Bill 15 goes by temporarily. Senate Bill 504, a bill relating to vested rights, rulings, or orders of the local circuit court, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments and...

[04:40:40] Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the amendments from the Committee of Courts of Justice be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no.

[04:40:57] The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 504 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[04:41:13] Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 714, a bill relating to duties and responsibilities of local pretrial services officers' assessments reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments.

[04:41:39] Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the amendments from the Committee on Courts of Justice be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to.

[04:41:55] Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I now move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 714 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced.

[04:42:12] Senate Bill 764, a bill relating to deferred disposition in criminal case, license suspension, driving while under the influence. Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments, and there is a floor amendment.

[04:42:31] Senator from Franklin County. Somewhere. Thank you, Madam President. I now move that the Committee amendments be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to?

[04:42:47] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. Senator from Franklin. Madam President, I now yield to the Senator from Eastern Fairfax for one of those most famous, the 400th of the session, Suravell amendments.

[04:43:08] The Chair recognizes the Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move to waive reading of the Floor Amendment. The question is, shall the reading of the Floor Amendment be waived? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The reading of the Floor Amendment is waived.

[04:43:25] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move the Floor Amendment. Speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, the Senate, first of all, I want to thank the Senator from Franklin County for bringing this bill. This bill sort of builds upon and cleans up some work we did back, I think, in 2020 regarding deferred dispositions. And what that bill did was allowed a court to defer a criminal charge and dismiss it or convict somebody of a lower charge with the agreement of the Commonwealth and the defense. The reason we had to do that was because the Supreme Court

[04:44:03] of Virginia in 2014 decided a case called Stars v. Commonwealth, which took away the power of the court to do that, which was something that all of us thought courts had had the power to do for hundreds of years what this bill what this floor amendment does is finishes that work before that stars case came down a party could go to a judge and ask a judge say i plead guilty but will you please continue a charge and dismiss it if i do some things and a court could do that without the blessing of the commonwealth at the time we passed this in 2014 the then chairman of the um over in the house said he didn't agree with that so we left this commonwealth

[04:44:41] agreement piece in now we're removing it and this takes the law back to what it was before 2014 was what everybody thought the law was before the Supreme Court came down with that opinion I hope we can adopt the floor amendment the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Prince William

thank you madam president madam president I rise to speak in support of the floor amendment senator has the floor thank you madam president madam president we vet judges at a very high level here in Virginia we take our time to listen to local community about judges to interview them and to make a decision to give them appointments. We give judges the discretion to sentence people to life in

[04:45:21] jail and we should also give them the ability to determine that someone should be entitled to have a case dismissed if they have successfully completed probation, treatment, classes, paid restitution, all without having to have the Commonwealth agree. The current language in 29802 has led many judges to believe that they cannot do these type of deferrals without the Commonwealth Attorney's agreement. There's nothing preventing a Commonwealth Attorney from making arguments and being heard by a judge before making a decision on a deferral. This floor amendment will take us back to what the law has historically

[04:45:59] been and that's to allow the final decision to be made by judges. So this floor amendment is about trusting our judges and putting the power back into the hands of our judges, especially for deferrals.

[04:46:16] The question is, shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The floor amendment is agreed to. Senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President.

[04:46:32] I now move that we engross in advance Senate Bill 764 to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 764 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[04:46:47] The bill is engrossed and advanced. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I now move that all the senator... Senator, my apologies.

[04:47:04] Returning to page 35, Senate Bill 15 is out of the block. Senator from Rockingham.

[04:47:20] I would ask that the bill go by for the day. objection. Senate Bill 15 goes by for the day. The chair from Eastern, sorry, the Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I now move that all the Senate bills are now on third reading on the, we're not uncontested, on the regular calendar, pages 35 through 37, Senate bills 15 through 764, that the rules be suspended and the third constitution reading the title be dispensed

[04:47:56] with. The question is, shall the rules be suspended and the third reading of the titles of the bills that are now on the third passage be dispensed with. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[04:48:12] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero.

[04:48:31] Ayes 39, no zero. The bills are now before the Senate on final passage. Senate Bill 504. Senator from Charlottesville.

[04:48:49] Madam President, I move that the bill passed. I'd like to speak to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, over a year ago, the city of Charlottesville changed their zoning ordinance to allow or basically allow the development of more housing.

[04:49:06] Housing is a huge issue in Charlottesville as it is in most parts of the state. Immediately some of the folks in Charlottesville filed suit to enjoin that process and over Over the course of about a year, they ended up losing, Charlottesville won.

[04:49:22] But in the meantime, a whole lot of investment was stranded and discouraged. What this bill does, it says if a landowner has vested rights in the development of at least 25 individual parcels, a court action can't stop it.

[04:49:41] I would ask you to vote for the bill. Senator from King George. Madam President, speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Madam President, I don't want to injure what they're trying to do in the city of Charlottesville, but I would point out to the members that this would take away the ability of a court of law to stop something. And I'm not aware that we do that in this General Assembly. If someone petitions the court for a reason, typically we stay out of the judicial branch and don't tell them they

[04:50:19] cannot intervene under any circumstances and that's what this bill does i mean if it's say they start moving dirt they find an indian burial ground they find a gas line that can't be disturbed and those are just bad examples but this bill would completely preclude the court from issuing an injunction or anything else and i just i don't think that i don't think we should be telling the

[04:50:49] court that they cannot intervene if the law requires them to. Senator from Charlottesville. Well, Madam Chair, if nobody else wants to speak out. Senator has the floor. Madam President, I apologize. In the process of developing property, in the process of obtaining permits, there are a lot of things that are subject to discovery. And I would suggest that a lot of the things that the Senator from King George is speaking about would be discovered during that process. But housing is a crisis, and if we're serious about fixing it, we've

[04:51:25] got to move forward and find ways to build more homes, and that's what this bill is simply about. So please vote for the bill. The question is, shall Senate Bill 504 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 17. Ayes 21, noes 17. Senate Bill 504 passes. Senate Bill

[04:52:03] 714. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the bill pass and I'd like to speak to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, this deals with, this bill deals with the duties of local pretrial service officers. It makes a couple of changes. Number one, it replaces the word interview with conduct a risk assessment of and that that acknowledges the current practice where interviews don't always take place but the second thing it does is it clarifies that an interview is still an option is still

[04:52:40] something that the interviewer can or that the pre-trial officer can do it's designed to make the pre-trial office more pre-trial process more effective I'd ask you vote for the bill the question is shall Senate bill 714 pass. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no.

[04:53:01] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, no 16. Ayes 23, no 16. Senate Bill 714 passes. Senate Bill 764. Senator from Franklin County.

[04:53:24] Thank you, Madam President. I now move that Senate Bill 764 pass in speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Members of the you've heard a bit of this bill on the amendment process what this bill basically does is gives the ability for the defense to ask for and a court to consider and and to accept a disposition to a court case in a in a driving offense such as drunk driving to allow for a deferred disposition where that deferred disposition can result if the defendant complies with

all requirements put forth by the court in a probationary kind of status and whatever it is community service maybe some suspension the driver's license whatever it is in

[04:54:02] this driving offense then to defer it to either lessen the charge or to have it dismissed based on the facts the case man president every case my 31 years of practicing criminal defense and traffic law is a unique case and sometimes those unique cases require a disposition that is not with a guilty verdict necessarily but a way that that defendant can work through it and achieve the trust of the court, the trust of the community, and ultimately not pay a price that it would have otherwise paid.

[04:54:32] There are a number of times where you'll go in with a client where the case is close, not guilty, may be guilty, and what we decide on is controlling the outcome for our clients that allow them to work through the process, and they're not risking maybe a conviction that would affect them for the rest of their lives. And so what this enables us to do is to have the court be empowered with the discretion as was so eloquently described by the senator from eastern prince william to leave with the court the discretion that we trust in them every time we elect them here in the general assembly with them to call balls and strikes based on the facts that they see at the time before them and i think that's the right thing to do and therefore that's what this bill does and so i

[04:55:12] move its passage the senator from orange thank you madam president speaking to the bill senator has the floor madam president a couple years ago when uh delegate bell was here he was zero tolerance on duis and everything else was very hard to get anything out of the house to to try to help folks and we set up a veteran's docket madam president and one of the things that we had a real challenge with was allowing the judges in the veterans docket when these veterans go through this program for 18 months is once they decide that they're done if they were holding over the

[04:55:49] same situation they would lose their driver's license even though it completed the whole course so how would they get to work and everything else so I think this is a bill that's worthy of worthy of our votes to give people that opportunity to make a living if they clean themselves up and get through this process so I ask everybody vote yes the question is shall Senate bill 764 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes I those opposed no are the senators ready to vote. Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[04:56:26] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37, noes 2. Ayes 37, noes 2. Senate Bill 764 passes. Supplemental Calendar Number 1. Regular Calendar House Bill on Second Reading. House Bill 29.

[04:56:48] Budget Bill. Amends and reenacts Chapter 725 of the Acts of Assembly of 2025, which appropriates the public revenues for two years ending respectively on june 30th 2025 and june 30th 2026 the senator from eastern fairfax uh inquiry the clerk does that complete senator evans last

[04:57:20] calendar it does is there any other business to come before the senate senator from hampton madam president i rise on a point of personal privilege the senator has the floor thank you Madam President, I'm pretty sure that we are all aware of the passing of the Reverend Jesse Jackson earlier this morning. Reverend Jesse Jackson was an icon of the civil rights movement and again he died early today. Reverend

[04:57:56] Jackson was a disciple of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. He was founder and president of the National Rainbow Push Coalition. He was twice a candidate for president in 1984 and 1988 and as such he organized and registered millions of black voters. Although a native of South Carolina and a resident of

Chicago his connection to Virginia was through his wife Jacqueline who was from Newport News. I knew his mother-in-law Gertrude Brown well as she would diligently work hard and eventually earned her Bachelor of Arts degree in sociology from Hampton

[04:58:34] University at the age of 65. Reverend Jackson served as the 1988 commencement speaker when she earned that degree. He lived an extraordinary life as an activist and a committed soldier to uplifting the lives of all. I move that when we adjourn today we do so in honor and memory of the Reverend Jesse Lewis Jackson. Thank you Senator. The Senator from Orange. Thank you - Madam President, I rise for a brief announcement.

[04:59:08] - Senator has the floor. - Madam President, it is that time of the year for our 15th Annual Military Appreciation Night, Thursday, February 19th from six to eight at the War Memorial. - Thank you, Senator. - Thank you, Madam President. - The junior senator from Loudoun.

[04:59:23] - Thank you, Madam President. I rise for a point of personal privilege. - Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. Today I rise to celebrate Lunar New Year, one of the most meaningful holidays for Virginians, the Asian American and Pacific Islander community. I'm proud to serve alongside my colleagues in the Virginia Asian/American Pacific Islander Caucus, which this year stands, Madam President, a record 10 members strong, a reflection of the growing voice and influence of our community across the Commonwealth.

[04:59:52] Across Virginia, families will don dread to invite luck and prosperity, gather over bountiful meals, and look forward to the hope and renewal of spring after a long winter. Today marks the end of the year of the snake and the beginning of the year of the horse.

[05:00:09] The year tradition associated with boldness, courage, and transformation. In that spirit, I wish everyone celebrating this Lunar New Year courage in your convictions, optimism in the face of adversity, and a spirit of inclusion and goodwill towards all.

[05:00:27] Happy Lunar New Year to all those who celebrate. Thank you, Madam President. Thank you, Senator. The chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth. Oh, my apologies.

[05:00:44] The clerk will report any announcements on the desk. I would be fine not reading anything else. Tuesday, February 17th, the Committee on Privileges and Elections will not meet. The Committee on Agriculture and Conservation, Agriculture, Conservation, and Natural Resources will not meet.

[05:01:04] The Finance Appropriations Subcommittee on Education will not meet. Tomorrow, Wednesday, February 18th, The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Public Safety and Claims will meet at 8 a.m. in the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th Floor, GAB.

[05:01:22] This is a time change. The Women's Legislative Roundtable will meet virtually at 8:30 a.m. The Committee on Finance and Appropriations will meet at 9 a.m. in Senate Room A, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11:15 in Senate Room 1 of the Capitol.

[05:01:41] The Republican caucus will meet at 11:30 in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. The Senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 12:00 noon on tomorrow, and that we adjourn in name, in memory, and honor of the Reverend Dr. Jesse Lewis Jackson.

[05:02:04] The question is, shall the Senate now adjourn until 12:00 noon tomorrow, and as we adjourn, do so in the memory of the Reverend Jesse Lewis Jackson? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[05:02:20] The motion is agreed to. The Senate stands adjourned until 12 noon tomorrow.

[05:02:48] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's YouTube channel.

[05:03:52] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

